

## SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

# Wildlife Protection Act and Schedules - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

| Wildlife Protection Act and Schedules            |                                                                                                                                             |
|--------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| REFRESHED TEACHING NAVIGATION — BASIC/CORE FIRST |                                                                                                                                             |
| 01                                               | <b>FOUNDATION — LEGAL VINTAGE AND SIX-TO-FOUR RESTRUCTURING</b><br>Every answer must identify whether it uses the pre-2022 six-schedule     |
| 02                                               | <b>FOUNDATION — SCHEDULE I ANIMALS</b><br>Mechanism chain: Schedule I Qualified use: State the highest                                      |
| 03                                               | <b>FOUNDATION — SCHEDULE II ANIMALS</b><br>Technically, FOUNDATION — Schedule II animals is analysed by                                     |
| 04                                               | <b>CORE — SCHEDULE III PLANTS</b><br>Mechanism chain: Schedule III Qualified use: Identify the plant                                        |
| 05                                               | <b>CORE — SCHEDULE IV CITES SPECIMENS</b><br>Mechanism chain: Schedule IV Qualified use: Describe Schedule IV as                            |
| 06                                               | <b>CORE — SPECIES PLACEMENT AND VERMIN TIME POINT</b><br>Exact species-to-schedule placement can change through the                         |
| 07                                               | <b>CORE — HUNTING PROHIBITION</b><br>Mechanism chain: Hunting prohibition Qualified use: Start from                                         |
| 08                                               | <b>CORE — PERMIT AND EXCEPTION ARCHITECTURE</b><br>Scientific, educational, collection or management purposes do not                        |
| 09                                               | <b>CORE — DANGEROUS OR BEYOND-RECOVERY ROUTE</b><br>Mechanism chain: Dangerous or beyond recovery route Qualified use:                      |
| 10                                               | <b>CORE — CITES MANAGEMENT AUTHORITY</b><br>The post-2022 framework requires a Management Authority for                                     |
| 11                                               | <b>CORE — SCIENTIFIC AUTHORITY AND CHAPTER VB</b><br>Technically, CORE — Scientific Authority and Chapter VB is analysed                    |
| 12                                               | <b>CORE — INVASIVE ALIEN SPECIES POWER</b><br>Technically, CORE — Invasive alien species power is analysed by                               |
| 13                                               | <b>CORE SYNTHESIS — WCCB STATUTORY ROLE</b><br>Mains: Use sections 38Y and 38Z only for the WCCB role confirmed by                          |
| 14                                               | <b>CORE SYNTHESIS — STATE, CHIEF WILDLIFE WARDEN, NBWL AND NTCA ROLES</b><br>NBWL and NTCA exercise protected-area and tiger-specific roles |
| 15                                               | <b>CORE SYNTHESIS — SCIENCE-LAW-TRADE AND AUDITED PYQ BOUNDARY</b><br>Technically, CORE SYNTHESIS — Science-law-trade and audited PYQ       |

Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

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# Wildlife Protection Act and Schedules - Solved Practice Workbook

Authoring-only generation: 2026-09-06. Uses the same source-bounded ecological distinctions and strict A-B-C-D rotation.

## BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

### Q1. Which statement correctly identifies Legal vintage first?

A. Every answer must identify whether it uses the pre-2022 six-schedule structure or the post-2022 four-schedule structure of the Wildlife Protection Act. B. The Wildlife Protection Amendment Act 2022 restructured the earlier six schedules into four; an older PYQ may still test the law in force at its own time point. C. Under the post-2022 owner framework, Schedule I lists animals receiving the greatest degree of protection; no species placement is assumed without the current schedule. D. Schedule II lists animals receiving a lesser degree of protection than Schedule I, while still remaining protected under the Act.

**Answer: A. Explanation: Every answer must identify whether it uses the pre-2022 six-schedule structure or the post-2022 four-schedule structure of the Wildlife Protection Act. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.**

### Q2. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Legal vintage first?

A. Under the post-2022 owner framework, Schedule I lists animals receiving the greatest degree of protection; no species placement is assumed without the current schedule. B. Every answer must identify whether it uses the pre-2022 six-schedule structure or the post-2022 four-schedule structure of the Wildlife Protection Act. C. Schedule II lists animals receiving a lesser degree of protection than Schedule I, while still remaining protected under the Act. D. Post-2022 Schedule III is the specified plant schedule; it is not a third animal-protection tier and replaces the function of old Schedule VI.

**Answer: B. Explanation: Every answer must identify whether it uses the pre-2022 six-schedule structure or the post-2022 four-schedule structure of the Wildlife Protection Act. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.**

### Q3. Which statement uses Legal vintage first without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Schedule II lists animals receiving a lesser degree of protection than Schedule I, while still remaining protected under the Act. B. Post-2022 Schedule III is the specified plant schedule; it is not a third animal-protection tier and replaces the function of old Schedule VI. C. Every answer must identify whether it uses the pre-2022 six-schedule structure or the post-2022 four-schedule structure of the Wildlife Protection Act. D. Post-2022 Schedule IV covers CITES-listed scheduled specimens for international trade regulation; it is not a higher protection rung than Schedule I or II.

**Answer: C. Explanation: Every answer must identify whether it uses the pre-2022 six-schedule structure or the post-2022 four-schedule structure of the Wildlife Protection Act. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.**

### Q4. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Legal vintage first?

A. Post-2022 Schedule III is the specified plant schedule; it is not a third animal-protection tier and replaces the function of old Schedule VI. B. Post-2022 Schedule IV covers CITES-listed scheduled specimens for international trade regulation; it is not a higher protection rung than Schedule I or II. C. Exact species-to-schedule placement can change through the applicable legal process and must be checked against the current consolidated schedule or notification. D. Every answer must identify whether it uses the pre-2022 six-schedule structure or the post-2022 four-schedule structure of the Wildlife Protection Act.

**Answer: D. Explanation: Every answer must identify whether it uses the pre-2022 six-schedule structure or the post-2022 four-schedule structure of the Wildlife Protection Act. The other options belong to different**

ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.

**Q5. Which statement correctly identifies Six schedules to four?**

A. The Wildlife Protection Amendment Act 2022 restructured the earlier six schedules into four; an older PYQ may still test the law in force at its own time point. B. Under the post-2022 owner framework, Schedule I lists animals receiving the greatest degree of protection; no species placement is assumed without the current schedule. C. Schedule II lists animals receiving a lesser degree of protection than Schedule I, while still remaining protected under the Act. D. Post-2022 Schedule III is the specified plant schedule; it is not a third animal-protection tier and replaces the function of old Schedule VI.

**Answer: A. Explanation: The Wildlife Protection Amendment Act 2022 restructured the earlier six schedules into four; an older PYQ may still test the law in force at its own time point. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.**

**Q6. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Six schedules to four?**

A. Schedule II lists animals receiving a lesser degree of protection than Schedule I, while still remaining protected under the Act. B. The Wildlife Protection Amendment Act 2022 restructured the earlier six schedules into four; an older PYQ may still test the law in force at its own time point. C. Post-2022 Schedule III is the specified plant schedule; it is not a third animal-protection tier and replaces the function of old Schedule VI. D. Post-2022 Schedule IV covers CITES-listed scheduled specimens for international trade regulation; it is not a higher protection rung than Schedule I or II.

**Answer: B. Explanation: The Wildlife Protection Amendment Act 2022 restructured the earlier six schedules into four; an older PYQ may still test the law in force at its own time point. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.**

**Q7. Which statement uses Six schedules to four without changing its scale, parameter or status?**

A. Post-2022 Schedule III is the specified plant schedule; it is not a third animal-protection tier and replaces the function of old Schedule VI. B. Post-2022 Schedule IV covers CITES-listed scheduled specimens for international trade regulation; it is not a higher protection rung than Schedule I or II. C. The Wildlife Protection Amendment Act 2022 restructured the earlier six schedules into four; an older PYQ may still test the law in force at its own time point. D. Exact species-to-schedule placement can change through the applicable legal process and must be checked against the current consolidated schedule or notification.

**Answer: C. Explanation: The Wildlife Protection Amendment Act 2022 restructured the earlier six schedules into four; an older PYQ may still test the law in force at its own time point. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.**

**Q8. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Six schedules to four?**

A. Post-2022 Schedule IV covers CITES-listed scheduled specimens for international trade regulation; it is not a higher protection rung than Schedule I or II. B. Exact species-to-schedule placement can change through the applicable legal process and must be checked against the current consolidated schedule or notification. C. The old Schedule V vermin list was omitted in 2022; the owner records a central notification route for a specified area and period and excludes Schedule I animals. D. The Wildlife Protection Amendment Act 2022 restructured the earlier six schedules into four; an older PYQ may still test the law in force at its own time point.

**Answer: D. Explanation: The Wildlife Protection Amendment Act 2022 restructured the earlier six schedules into four; an older PYQ may still test the law in force at its own time point. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.**

### Q9. Which statement correctly identifies Schedule I?

A. Under the post-2022 owner framework, Schedule I lists animals receiving the greatest degree of protection; no species placement is assumed without the current schedule. B. Schedule II lists animals receiving a lesser degree of protection than Schedule I, while still remaining protected under the Act. C. Post-2022 Schedule III is the specified plant schedule; it is not a third animal-protection tier and replaces the function of old Schedule VI. D. Post-2022 Schedule IV covers CITES-listed scheduled specimens for international trade regulation; it is not a higher protection rung than Schedule I or II.

**Answer: A. Explanation: Under the post-2022 owner framework, Schedule I lists animals receiving the greatest degree of protection; no species placement is assumed without the current schedule. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.**

### Q10. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Schedule I?

A. Post-2022 Schedule III is the specified plant schedule; it is not a third animal-protection tier and replaces the function of old Schedule VI. B. Under the post-2022 owner framework, Schedule I lists animals receiving the greatest degree of protection; no species placement is assumed without the current schedule. C. Post-2022 Schedule IV covers CITES-listed scheduled specimens for international trade regulation; it is not a higher protection rung than Schedule I or II. D. Exact species-to-schedule placement can change through the applicable legal process and must be checked against the current consolidated schedule or notification.

**Answer: B. Explanation: Under the post-2022 owner framework, Schedule I lists animals receiving the greatest degree of protection; no species placement is assumed without the current schedule. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.**

### Q11. Which statement uses Schedule I without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Post-2022 Schedule IV covers CITES-listed scheduled specimens for international trade regulation; it is not a higher protection rung than Schedule I or II. B. Exact species-to-schedule placement can change through the applicable legal process and must be checked against the current consolidated schedule or notification. C. Under the post-2022 owner framework, Schedule I lists animals receiving the greatest degree of protection; no species placement is assumed without the current schedule. D. The old Schedule V vermin list was omitted in 2022; the owner records a central notification route for a specified area and period and excludes Schedule I animals.

**Answer: C. Explanation: Under the post-2022 owner framework, Schedule I lists animals receiving the greatest degree of protection; no species placement is assumed without the current schedule. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.**

### Q12. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Schedule I?

A. Exact species-to-schedule placement can change through the applicable legal process and must be checked against the current consolidated schedule or notification. B. The old Schedule V vermin list was omitted in 2022; the owner records a central notification route for a specified area and period and excludes Schedule I animals. C. The Act's baseline is prohibition of hunting protected wild animals; a legal exception must be traced to its statutory condition, authority and written permission. D. Under the post-2022 owner framework, Schedule I lists animals receiving the greatest degree of protection; no species placement is assumed without the current schedule.

**Answer: D. Explanation: Under the post-2022 owner framework, Schedule I lists animals receiving the greatest degree of protection; no species placement is assumed without the current schedule. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.**



### Q13. Which statement correctly identifies Schedule II?

A. Schedule II lists animals receiving a lesser degree of protection than Schedule I, while still remaining protected under the Act. B. Post-2022 Schedule III is the specified plant schedule; it is not a third animal-protection tier and replaces the function of old Schedule VI. C. Post-2022 Schedule IV covers CITES-listed scheduled specimens for international trade regulation; it is not a higher protection rung than Schedule I or II. D. Exact species-to-schedule placement can change through the applicable legal process and must be checked against the current consolidated schedule or notification.

**Answer: A. Explanation: Schedule II lists animals receiving a lesser degree of protection than Schedule I, while still remaining protected under the Act. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.**

### Q14. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Schedule II?

A. Post-2022 Schedule IV covers CITES-listed scheduled specimens for international trade regulation; it is not a higher protection rung than Schedule I or II. B. Schedule II lists animals receiving a lesser degree of protection than Schedule I, while still remaining protected under the Act. C. Exact species-to-schedule placement can change through the applicable legal process and must be checked against the current consolidated schedule or notification. D. The old Schedule V vermin list was omitted in 2022; the owner records a central notification route for a specified area and period and excludes Schedule I animals.

**Answer: B. Explanation: Schedule II lists animals receiving a lesser degree of protection than Schedule I, while still remaining protected under the Act. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.**

### Q15. Which statement uses Schedule II without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Exact species-to-schedule placement can change through the applicable legal process and must be checked against the current consolidated schedule or notification. B. The old Schedule V vermin list was omitted in 2022; the owner records a central notification route for a specified area and period and excludes Schedule I animals. C. Schedule II lists animals receiving a lesser degree of protection than Schedule I, while still remaining protected under the Act. D. The Act's baseline is prohibition of hunting protected wild animals; a legal exception must be traced to its statutory condition, authority and written permission.

**Answer: C. Explanation: Schedule II lists animals receiving a lesser degree of protection than Schedule I, while still remaining protected under the Act. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.**

### Q16. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Schedule II?

A. The old Schedule V vermin list was omitted in 2022; the owner records a central notification route for a specified area and period and excludes Schedule I animals. B. The Act's baseline is prohibition of hunting protected wild animals; a legal exception must be traced to its statutory condition, authority and written permission. C. Scientific, educational, collection or management purposes do not create a free-standing right to hunt; the applicable permit and statutory conditions remain necessary. D. Schedule II lists animals receiving a lesser degree of protection than Schedule I, while still remaining protected under the Act.

**Answer: D. Explanation: Schedule II lists animals receiving a lesser degree of protection than Schedule I, while still remaining protected under the Act. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.**



### Q17. Which statement correctly identifies Schedule III?

A. Post-2022 Schedule III is the specified plant schedule; it is not a third animal-protection tier and replaces the function of old Schedule VI. B. Post-2022 Schedule IV covers CITES-listed scheduled specimens for international trade regulation; it is not a higher protection rung than Schedule I or II. C. Exact species-to-schedule placement can change through the applicable legal process and must be checked against the current consolidated schedule or notification. D. The old Schedule V vermin list was omitted in 2022; the owner records a central notification route for a specified area and period and excludes Schedule I animals.

**Answer: A. Explanation: Post-2022 Schedule III is the specified plant schedule; it is not a third animal-protection tier and replaces the function of old Schedule VI. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.**

### Q18. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Schedule III?

A. Exact species-to-schedule placement can change through the applicable legal process and must be checked against the current consolidated schedule or notification. B. Post-2022 Schedule III is the specified plant schedule; it is not a third animal-protection tier and replaces the function of old Schedule VI. C. The old Schedule V vermin list was omitted in 2022; the owner records a central notification route for a specified area and period and excludes Schedule I animals. D. The Act's baseline is prohibition of hunting protected wild animals; a legal exception must be traced to its statutory condition, authority and written permission.

**Answer: B. Explanation: Post-2022 Schedule III is the specified plant schedule; it is not a third animal-protection tier and replaces the function of old Schedule VI. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.**

### Q19. Which statement uses Schedule III without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. The old Schedule V vermin list was omitted in 2022; the owner records a central notification route for a specified area and period and excludes Schedule I animals. B. The Act's baseline is prohibition of hunting protected wild animals; a legal exception must be traced to its statutory condition, authority and written permission. C. Post-2022 Schedule III is the specified plant schedule; it is not a third animal-protection tier and replaces the function of old Schedule VI. D. Scientific, educational, collection or management purposes do not create a free-standing right to hunt; the applicable permit and statutory conditions remain necessary.

**Answer: C. Explanation: Post-2022 Schedule III is the specified plant schedule; it is not a third animal-protection tier and replaces the function of old Schedule VI. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.**

### Q20. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Schedule III?

A. The Act's baseline is prohibition of hunting protected wild animals; a legal exception must be traced to its statutory condition, authority and written permission. B. Scientific, educational, collection or management purposes do not create a free-standing right to hunt; the applicable permit and statutory conditions remain necessary. C. The owner records narrow action where an animal is dangerous to human life or disabled or diseased beyond recovery, with the competent authority depending on schedule and provision. D. Post-2022 Schedule III is the specified plant schedule; it is not a third animal-protection tier and replaces the function of old Schedule VI.

**Answer: D. Explanation: Post-2022 Schedule III is the specified plant schedule; it is not a third animal-protection tier and replaces the function of old Schedule VI. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.**

### Q21. Which statement correctly identifies Schedule IV?

A. Post-2022 Schedule IV covers CITES-listed scheduled specimens for international trade regulation; it is not a higher protection rung than Schedule I or II. B. Exact species-to-schedule placement can change through the applicable legal process and must be checked against the current consolidated schedule or notification. C. The old Schedule V vermin list was omitted in 2022; the owner records a central notification route for a specified area and period and excludes Schedule I animals. D. The Act's baseline is prohibition of hunting protected wild animals; a legal exception must be traced to its statutory condition, authority and written permission.

**Answer: A. Explanation: Post-2022 Schedule IV covers CITES-listed scheduled specimens for international trade regulation; it is not a higher protection rung than Schedule I or II. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.**

### Q22. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Schedule IV?

A. The old Schedule V vermin list was omitted in 2022; the owner records a central notification route for a specified area and period and excludes Schedule I animals. B. Post-2022 Schedule IV covers CITES-listed scheduled specimens for international trade regulation; it is not a higher protection rung than Schedule I or II. C. The Act's baseline is prohibition of hunting protected wild animals; a legal exception must be traced to its statutory condition, authority and written permission. D. Scientific, educational, collection or management purposes do not create a free-standing right to hunt; the applicable permit and statutory conditions remain necessary.

**Answer: B. Explanation: Post-2022 Schedule IV covers CITES-listed scheduled specimens for international trade regulation; it is not a higher protection rung than Schedule I or II. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.**

### Q23. Which statement uses Schedule IV without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. The Act's baseline is prohibition of hunting protected wild animals; a legal exception must be traced to its statutory condition, authority and written permission. B. Scientific, educational, collection or management purposes do not create a free-standing right to hunt; the applicable permit and statutory conditions remain necessary. C. Post-2022 Schedule IV covers CITES-listed scheduled specimens for international trade regulation; it is not a higher protection rung than Schedule I or II. D. The owner records narrow action where an animal is dangerous to human life or disabled or diseased beyond recovery, with the competent authority depending on schedule and provision.

**Answer: C. Explanation: Post-2022 Schedule IV covers CITES-listed scheduled specimens for international trade regulation; it is not a higher protection rung than Schedule I or II. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.**

### Q24. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Schedule IV?

A. Scientific, educational, collection or management purposes do not create a free-standing right to hunt; the applicable permit and statutory conditions remain necessary. B. The owner records narrow action where an animal is dangerous to human life or disabled or diseased beyond recovery, with the competent authority depending on schedule and provision. C. The post-2022 framework requires a Management Authority for permits and certificates in international trade in scheduled specimens. D. Post-2022 Schedule IV covers CITES-listed scheduled specimens for international trade regulation; it is not a higher protection rung than Schedule I or II.

**Answer: D. Explanation: Post-2022 Schedule IV covers CITES-listed scheduled specimens for international trade regulation; it is not a higher protection rung than Schedule I or II. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.**

### Q25. Which statement correctly identifies Species placement discipline?

A. Exact species-to-schedule placement can change through the applicable legal process and must be checked against the current consolidated schedule or notification. B. The old Schedule V vermin list was omitted in 2022; the owner records a central notification route for a specified area and period and excludes Schedule I animals. C. The Act's baseline is prohibition of hunting protected wild animals; a legal exception must be traced to its statutory condition, authority and written permission. D. Scientific, educational, collection or management purposes do not create a free-standing right to hunt; the applicable permit and statutory conditions remain necessary.

**Answer: A. Explanation: Exact species-to-schedule placement can change through the applicable legal process and must be checked against the current consolidated schedule or notification. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.**

### Q26. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Species placement discipline?

A. The Act's baseline is prohibition of hunting protected wild animals; a legal exception must be traced to its statutory condition, authority and written permission. B. Exact species-to-schedule placement can change through the applicable legal process and must be checked against the current consolidated schedule or notification. C. Scientific, educational, collection or management purposes do not create a free-standing right to hunt; the applicable permit and statutory conditions remain necessary. D. The owner records narrow action where an animal is dangerous to human life or disabled or diseased beyond recovery, with the competent authority depending on schedule and provision.

**Answer: B. Explanation: Exact species-to-schedule placement can change through the applicable legal process and must be checked against the current consolidated schedule or notification. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.**

### Q27. Which statement uses Species placement discipline without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Scientific, educational, collection or management purposes do not create a free-standing right to hunt; the applicable permit and statutory conditions remain necessary. B. The owner records narrow action where an animal is dangerous to human life or disabled or diseased beyond recovery, with the competent authority depending on schedule and provision. C. Exact species-to-schedule placement can change through the applicable legal process and must be checked against the current consolidated schedule or notification. D. The post-2022 framework requires a Management Authority for permits and certificates in international trade in scheduled specimens.

**Answer: C. Explanation: Exact species-to-schedule placement can change through the applicable legal process and must be checked against the current consolidated schedule or notification. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.**

### Q28. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Species placement discipline?

A. The owner records narrow action where an animal is dangerous to human life or disabled or diseased beyond recovery, with the competent authority depending on schedule and provision. B. The post-2022 framework requires a Management Authority for permits and certificates in international trade in scheduled specimens. C. The Scientific Authority advises on the conservation consequences of trade; it performs a different function from the permit-issuing Management Authority. D. Exact species-to-schedule placement can change through the applicable legal process and must be checked against the current consolidated schedule or notification.

**Answer: D. Explanation: Exact species-to-schedule placement can change through the applicable legal process and must be checked against the current consolidated schedule or notification. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.**

### Q29. Which statement correctly identifies Vermin time point?

A. The old Schedule V vermin list was omitted in 2022; the owner records a central notification route for a specified area and period and excludes Schedule I animals. B. The Act's baseline is prohibition of hunting protected wild animals; a legal exception must be traced to its statutory condition, authority and written permission. C. Scientific, educational, collection or management purposes do not create a free-standing right to hunt; the applicable permit and statutory conditions remain necessary. D. The owner records narrow action where an animal is dangerous to human life or disabled or diseased beyond recovery, with the competent authority depending on schedule and provision.

**Answer: A. Explanation: The old Schedule V vermin list was omitted in 2022; the owner records a central notification route for a specified area and period and excludes Schedule I animals. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.**

### Q30. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Vermin time point?

A. Scientific, educational, collection or management purposes do not create a free-standing right to hunt; the applicable permit and statutory conditions remain necessary. B. The old Schedule V vermin list was omitted in 2022; the owner records a central notification route for a specified area and period and excludes Schedule I animals. C. The owner records narrow action where an animal is dangerous to human life or disabled or diseased beyond recovery, with the competent authority depending on schedule and provision. D. The post-2022 framework requires a Management Authority for permits and certificates in international trade in scheduled specimens.

**Answer: B. Explanation: The old Schedule V vermin list was omitted in 2022; the owner records a central notification route for a specified area and period and excludes Schedule I animals. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.**

### Q31. Which statement uses Vermin time point without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. The owner records narrow action where an animal is dangerous to human life or disabled or diseased beyond recovery, with the competent authority depending on schedule and provision. B. The post-2022 framework requires a Management Authority for permits and certificates in international trade in scheduled specimens. C. The old Schedule V vermin list was omitted in 2022; the owner records a central notification route for a specified area and period and excludes Schedule I animals. D. The Scientific Authority advises on the conservation consequences of trade; it performs a different function from the permit-issuing Management Authority.

**Answer: C. Explanation: The old Schedule V vermin list was omitted in 2022; the owner records a central notification route for a specified area and period and excludes Schedule I animals. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.**

### Q32. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Vermin time point?

A. The post-2022 framework requires a Management Authority for permits and certificates in international trade in scheduled specimens. B. The Scientific Authority advises on the conservation consequences of trade; it performs a different function from the permit-issuing Management Authority. C. The 2022 amendment inserted a dedicated international-trade chapter for scheduled specimens, translating CITES obligations into domestic legal machinery. D. The old Schedule V vermin list was omitted in 2022; the owner records a central notification route for a specified area and period and excludes Schedule I animals.

**Answer: D. Explanation: The old Schedule V vermin list was omitted in 2022; the owner records a central notification route for a specified area and period and excludes Schedule I animals. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.**

### Q33. Which statement correctly identifies Hunting prohibition?

A. The Act's baseline is prohibition of hunting protected wild animals; a legal exception must be traced to its statutory condition, authority and written permission. B. Scientific, educational, collection or management purposes do not create a free-standing right to hunt; the applicable permit and statutory conditions remain necessary. C. The owner records narrow action where an animal is dangerous to human life or disabled or diseased beyond recovery, with the competent authority depending on schedule and provision. D. The post-2022 framework requires a Management Authority for permits and certificates in international trade in scheduled specimens.

**Answer: A. Explanation: The Act's baseline is prohibition of hunting protected wild animals; a legal exception must be traced to its statutory condition, authority and written permission. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.**

### Q34. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Hunting prohibition?

A. The owner records narrow action where an animal is dangerous to human life or disabled or diseased beyond recovery, with the competent authority depending on schedule and provision. B. The Act's baseline is prohibition of hunting protected wild animals; a legal exception must be traced to its statutory condition, authority and written permission. C. The post-2022 framework requires a Management Authority for permits and certificates in international trade in scheduled specimens. D. The Scientific Authority advises on the conservation consequences of trade; it performs a different function from the permit-issuing Management Authority.

**Answer: B. Explanation: The Act's baseline is prohibition of hunting protected wild animals; a legal exception must be traced to its statutory condition, authority and written permission. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.**

### Q35. Which statement uses Hunting prohibition without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. The post-2022 framework requires a Management Authority for permits and certificates in international trade in scheduled specimens. B. The Scientific Authority advises on the conservation consequences of trade; it performs a different function from the permit-issuing Management Authority. C. The Act's baseline is prohibition of hunting protected wild animals; a legal exception must be traced to its statutory condition, authority and written permission. D. The 2022 amendment inserted a dedicated international-trade chapter for scheduled specimens, translating CITES obligations into domestic legal machinery.

**Answer: C. Explanation: The Act's baseline is prohibition of hunting protected wild animals; a legal exception must be traced to its statutory condition, authority and written permission. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.**

### Q36. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Hunting prohibition?

A. The Scientific Authority advises on the conservation consequences of trade; it performs a different function from the permit-issuing Management Authority. B. The 2022 amendment inserted a dedicated international-trade chapter for scheduled specimens, translating CITES obligations into domestic legal machinery. C. The amendment empowered the Central Government to regulate or prohibit the import, trade, possession or proliferation of invasive alien species under the applicable provision. D. The Act's baseline is prohibition of hunting protected wild animals; a legal exception must be traced to its statutory condition, authority and written permission.

**Answer: D. Explanation: The Act's baseline is prohibition of hunting protected wild animals; a legal exception must be traced to its statutory condition, authority and written permission. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.**

### Q37. Which statement correctly identifies Permit and exception?

A. Scientific, educational, collection or management purposes do not create a free-standing right to hunt; the applicable permit and statutory conditions remain necessary. B. The owner records narrow action where an animal is dangerous to human life or disabled or diseased beyond recovery, with the competent authority depending on schedule and provision. C. The post-2022 framework requires a Management Authority for permits and certificates in international trade in scheduled specimens. D. The Scientific Authority advises on the conservation consequences of trade; it performs a different function from the permit-issuing Management Authority.

**Answer: A. Explanation: Scientific, educational, collection or management purposes do not create a free-standing right to hunt; the applicable permit and statutory conditions remain necessary. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.**

### Q38. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Permit and exception?

A. The post-2022 framework requires a Management Authority for permits and certificates in international trade in scheduled specimens. B. Scientific, educational, collection or management purposes do not create a free-standing right to hunt; the applicable permit and statutory conditions remain necessary. C. The Scientific Authority advises on the conservation consequences of trade; it performs a different function from the permit-issuing Management Authority. D. The 2022 amendment inserted a dedicated international-trade chapter for scheduled specimens, translating CITES obligations into domestic legal machinery.

**Answer: B. Explanation: Scientific, educational, collection or management purposes do not create a free-standing right to hunt; the applicable permit and statutory conditions remain necessary. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.**

### Q39. Which statement uses Permit and exception without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. The Scientific Authority advises on the conservation consequences of trade; it performs a different function from the permit-issuing Management Authority. B. The 2022 amendment inserted a dedicated international-trade chapter for scheduled specimens, translating CITES obligations into domestic legal machinery. C. Scientific, educational, collection or management purposes do not create a free-standing right to hunt; the applicable permit and statutory conditions remain necessary. D. The amendment empowered the Central Government to regulate or prohibit the import, trade, possession or proliferation of invasive alien species under the applicable provision.

**Answer: C. Explanation: Scientific, educational, collection or management purposes do not create a free-standing right to hunt; the applicable permit and statutory conditions remain necessary. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.**

### Q40. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Permit and exception?

A. The 2022 amendment inserted a dedicated international-trade chapter for scheduled specimens, translating CITES obligations into domestic legal machinery. B. The amendment empowered the Central Government to regulate or prohibit the import, trade, possession or proliferation of invasive alien species under the applicable provision. C. MoEFCC's retrievable page states that WCCB was constituted under section 38Y and lists section 38Z functions including intelligence, coordination, capacity and international cooperation. D. Scientific, educational, collection or management purposes do not create a free-standing right to hunt; the applicable permit and statutory conditions remain necessary.

**Answer: D. Explanation: Scientific, educational, collection or management purposes do not create a free-standing right to hunt; the applicable permit and statutory conditions remain necessary. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.**



#### Q41. Which statement correctly identifies Dangerous or beyond recovery route?

A. The owner records narrow action where an animal is dangerous to human life or disabled or diseased beyond recovery, with the competent authority depending on schedule and provision. B. The post-2022 framework requires a Management Authority for permits and certificates in international trade in scheduled specimens. C. The Scientific Authority advises on the conservation consequences of trade; it performs a different function from the permit-issuing Management Authority. D. The 2022 amendment inserted a dedicated international-trade chapter for scheduled specimens, translating CITES obligations into domestic legal machinery.

**Answer: A. Explanation: The owner records narrow action where an animal is dangerous to human life or disabled or diseased beyond recovery, with the competent authority depending on schedule and provision. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.**

#### Q42. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Dangerous or beyond recovery route?

A. The Scientific Authority advises on the conservation consequences of trade; it performs a different function from the permit-issuing Management Authority. B. The owner records narrow action where an animal is dangerous to human life or disabled or diseased beyond recovery, with the competent authority depending on schedule and provision. C. The 2022 amendment inserted a dedicated international-trade chapter for scheduled specimens, translating CITES obligations into domestic legal machinery. D. The amendment empowered the Central Government to regulate or prohibit the import, trade, possession or proliferation of invasive alien species under the applicable provision.

**Answer: B. Explanation: The owner records narrow action where an animal is dangerous to human life or disabled or diseased beyond recovery, with the competent authority depending on schedule and provision. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.**

#### Q43. Which statement uses Dangerous or beyond recovery route without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. The 2022 amendment inserted a dedicated international-trade chapter for scheduled specimens, translating CITES obligations into domestic legal machinery. B. The amendment empowered the Central Government to regulate or prohibit the import, trade, possession or proliferation of invasive alien species under the applicable provision. C. The owner records narrow action where an animal is dangerous to human life or disabled or diseased beyond recovery, with the competent authority depending on schedule and provision. D. MoEFCC's retrievable page states that WCCB was constituted under section 38Y and lists section 38Z functions including intelligence, coordination, capacity and international cooperation.

**Answer: C. Explanation: The owner records narrow action where an animal is dangerous to human life or disabled or diseased beyond recovery, with the competent authority depending on schedule and provision. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.**

#### Q44. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Dangerous or beyond recovery route?

A. The amendment empowered the Central Government to regulate or prohibit the import, trade, possession or proliferation of invasive alien species under the applicable provision. B. MoEFCC's retrievable page states that WCCB was constituted under section 38Y and lists section 38Z functions including intelligence, coordination, capacity and international cooperation. C. State wildlife departments and the Chief Wildlife Warden perform on-ground authorisation and enforcement functions; their jurisdiction must not be assigned to WCCB. D. The owner records narrow action where an animal is dangerous to human life or disabled or diseased beyond recovery, with the competent authority depending on schedule and provision.

**Answer: D. Explanation: The owner records narrow action where an animal is dangerous to human life or disabled or diseased beyond recovery, with the competent authority depending on schedule and provision. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.**



#### Q45. Which statement correctly identifies CITES Management Authority?

A. The post-2022 framework requires a Management Authority for permits and certificates in international trade in scheduled specimens. B. The Scientific Authority advises on the conservation consequences of trade; it performs a different function from the permit-issuing Management Authority. C. The 2022 amendment inserted a dedicated international-trade chapter for scheduled specimens, translating CITES obligations into domestic legal machinery. D. The amendment empowered the Central Government to regulate or prohibit the import, trade, possession or proliferation of invasive alien species under the applicable provision.

**Answer: A. Explanation: The post-2022 framework requires a Management Authority for permits and certificates in international trade in scheduled specimens. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.**

#### Q46. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of CITES Management Authority?

A. The 2022 amendment inserted a dedicated international-trade chapter for scheduled specimens, translating CITES obligations into domestic legal machinery. B. The post-2022 framework requires a Management Authority for permits and certificates in international trade in scheduled specimens. C. The amendment empowered the Central Government to regulate or prohibit the import, trade, possession or proliferation of invasive alien species under the applicable provision. D. MoEFCC's retrievable page states that WCCB was constituted under section 38Y and lists section 38Z functions including intelligence, coordination, capacity and international cooperation.

**Answer: B. Explanation: The post-2022 framework requires a Management Authority for permits and certificates in international trade in scheduled specimens. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.**

#### Q47. Which statement uses CITES Management Authority without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. The amendment empowered the Central Government to regulate or prohibit the import, trade, possession or proliferation of invasive alien species under the applicable provision. B. MoEFCC's retrievable page states that WCCB was constituted under section 38Y and lists section 38Z functions including intelligence, coordination, capacity and international cooperation. C. The post-2022 framework requires a Management Authority for permits and certificates in international trade in scheduled specimens. D. State wildlife departments and the Chief Wildlife Warden perform on-ground authorisation and enforcement functions; their jurisdiction must not be assigned to WCCB.

**Answer: C. Explanation: The post-2022 framework requires a Management Authority for permits and certificates in international trade in scheduled specimens. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.**

#### Q48. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about CITES Management Authority?

A. MoEFCC's retrievable page states that WCCB was constituted under section 38Y and lists section 38Z functions including intelligence, coordination, capacity and international cooperation. B. State wildlife departments and the Chief Wildlife Warden perform on-ground authorisation and enforcement functions; their jurisdiction must not be assigned to WCCB. C. NBWL and NTCA exercise protected-area and tiger-specific roles under their respective provisions; they do not replace the Chief Wildlife Warden or CITES authorities. D. The post-2022 framework requires a Management Authority for permits and certificates in international trade in scheduled specimens.

**Answer: D. Explanation: The post-2022 framework requires a Management Authority for permits and certificates in international trade in scheduled specimens. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.**

#### Q49. Which statement correctly identifies CITES Scientific Authority?

A. The Scientific Authority advises on the conservation consequences of trade; it performs a different function from the permit-issuing Management Authority. B. The 2022 amendment inserted a dedicated international-trade chapter for scheduled specimens, translating CITES obligations into domestic legal machinery. C. The amendment empowered the Central Government to regulate or prohibit the import, trade, possession or proliferation of invasive alien species under the applicable provision. D. MoEFCC's retrievable page states that WCCB was constituted under section 38Y and lists section 38Z functions including intelligence, coordination, capacity and international cooperation.

**Answer: A. Explanation: The Scientific Authority advises on the conservation consequences of trade; it performs a different function from the permit-issuing Management Authority. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.**

#### Q50. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of CITES Scientific Authority?

A. The amendment empowered the Central Government to regulate or prohibit the import, trade, possession or proliferation of invasive alien species under the applicable provision. B. The Scientific Authority advises on the conservation consequences of trade; it performs a different function from the permit-issuing Management Authority. C. MoEFCC's retrievable page states that WCCB was constituted under section 38Y and lists section 38Z functions including intelligence, coordination, capacity and international cooperation. D. State wildlife departments and the Chief Wildlife Warden perform on-ground authorisation and enforcement functions; their jurisdiction must not be assigned to WCCB.

**Answer: B. Explanation: The Scientific Authority advises on the conservation consequences of trade; it performs a different function from the permit-issuing Management Authority. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.**

#### Q51. Which statement uses CITES Scientific Authority without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. MoEFCC's retrievable page states that WCCB was constituted under section 38Y and lists section 38Z functions including intelligence, coordination, capacity and international cooperation. B. State wildlife departments and the Chief Wildlife Warden perform on-ground authorisation and enforcement functions; their jurisdiction must not be assigned to WCCB. C. The Scientific Authority advises on the conservation consequences of trade; it performs a different function from the permit-issuing Management Authority. D. NBWL and NTCA exercise protected-area and tiger-specific roles under their respective provisions; they do not replace the Chief Wildlife Warden or CITES authorities.

**Answer: C. Explanation: The Scientific Authority advises on the conservation consequences of trade; it performs a different function from the permit-issuing Management Authority. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.**

#### Q52. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about CITES Scientific Authority?

A. State wildlife departments and the Chief Wildlife Warden perform on-ground authorisation and enforcement functions; their jurisdiction must not be assigned to WCCB. B. NBWL and NTCA exercise protected-area and tiger-specific roles under their respective provisions; they do not replace the Chief Wildlife Warden or CITES authorities. C. IUCN category assesses extinction risk, Wildlife Protection Act schedules create domestic legal consequences, and CITES regulates international trade; the three systems are related but distinct. D. The Scientific Authority advises on the conservation consequences of trade; it performs a different function from the permit-issuing Management Authority.

**Answer: D. Explanation: The Scientific Authority advises on the conservation consequences of trade; it performs a different function from the permit-issuing Management Authority. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.**

### Q53. Which statement correctly identifies Chapter VB trade architecture?

A. The 2022 amendment inserted a dedicated international-trade chapter for scheduled specimens, translating CITES obligations into domestic legal machinery. B. The amendment empowered the Central Government to regulate or prohibit the import, trade, possession or proliferation of invasive alien species under the applicable provision. C. MoEFCC's retrievable page states that WCCB was constituted under section 38Y and lists section 38Z functions including intelligence, coordination, capacity and international cooperation. D. State wildlife departments and the Chief Wildlife Warden perform on-ground authorisation and enforcement functions; their jurisdiction must not be assigned to WCCB.

**Answer: A. Explanation: The 2022 amendment inserted a dedicated international-trade chapter for scheduled specimens, translating CITES obligations into domestic legal machinery. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.**

### Q54. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Chapter VB trade architecture?

A. MoEFCC's retrievable page states that WCCB was constituted under section 38Y and lists section 38Z functions including intelligence, coordination, capacity and international cooperation. B. The 2022 amendment inserted a dedicated international-trade chapter for scheduled specimens, translating CITES obligations into domestic legal machinery. C. State wildlife departments and the Chief Wildlife Warden perform on-ground authorisation and enforcement functions; their jurisdiction must not be assigned to WCCB. D. NBWL and NTCA exercise protected-area and tiger-specific roles under their respective provisions; they do not replace the Chief Wildlife Warden or CITES authorities.

**Answer: B. Explanation: The 2022 amendment inserted a dedicated international-trade chapter for scheduled specimens, translating CITES obligations into domestic legal machinery. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.**

### Q55. Which statement uses Chapter VB trade architecture without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. State wildlife departments and the Chief Wildlife Warden perform on-ground authorisation and enforcement functions; their jurisdiction must not be assigned to WCCB. B. NBWL and NTCA exercise protected-area and tiger-specific roles under their respective provisions; they do not replace the Chief Wildlife Warden or CITES authorities. C. The 2022 amendment inserted a dedicated international-trade chapter for scheduled specimens, translating CITES obligations into domestic legal machinery. D. IUCN category assesses extinction risk, Wildlife Protection Act schedules create domestic legal consequences, and CITES regulates international trade; the three systems are related but distinct.

**Answer: C. Explanation: The 2022 amendment inserted a dedicated international-trade chapter for scheduled specimens, translating CITES obligations into domestic legal machinery. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.**

### Q56. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Chapter VB trade architecture?

A. NBWL and NTCA exercise protected-area and tiger-specific roles under their respective provisions; they do not replace the Chief Wildlife Warden or CITES authorities. B. IUCN category assesses extinction risk, Wildlife Protection Act schedules create domestic legal consequences, and CITES regulates international trade; the three systems are related but distinct. C. Routed demands cover old Schedule VI plant implications, protected-animal provisions and a 2024 Indian Flying Fox vermin question; each must be answered at its legal time point without inferring an option key. D. The 2022 amendment inserted a dedicated international-trade chapter for scheduled specimens, translating CITES obligations into domestic legal machinery.

**Answer: D. Explanation: The 2022 amendment inserted a dedicated international-trade chapter for scheduled specimens, translating CITES obligations into domestic legal machinery. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.**

### Q57. Which statement correctly identifies Invasive alien species?

A. The amendment empowered the Central Government to regulate or prohibit the import, trade, possession or proliferation of invasive alien species under the applicable provision. B. MoEFCC's retrievable page states that WCCB was constituted under section 38Y and lists section 38Z functions including intelligence, coordination, capacity and international cooperation. C. State wildlife departments and the Chief Wildlife Warden perform on-ground authorisation and enforcement functions; their jurisdiction must not be assigned to WCCB. D. NBWL and NTCA exercise protected-area and tiger-specific roles under their respective provisions; they do not replace the Chief Wildlife Warden or CITES authorities.

**Answer: A. Explanation: The amendment empowered the Central Government to regulate or prohibit the import, trade, possession or proliferation of invasive alien species under the applicable provision. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.**

### Q58. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Invasive alien species?

A. State wildlife departments and the Chief Wildlife Warden perform on-ground authorisation and enforcement functions; their jurisdiction must not be assigned to WCCB. B. The amendment empowered the Central Government to regulate or prohibit the import, trade, possession or proliferation of invasive alien species under the applicable provision. C. NBWL and NTCA exercise protected-area and tiger-specific roles under their respective provisions; they do not replace the Chief Wildlife Warden or CITES authorities. D. IUCN category assesses extinction risk, Wildlife Protection Act schedules create domestic legal consequences, and CITES regulates international trade; the three systems are related but distinct.

**Answer: B. Explanation: The amendment empowered the Central Government to regulate or prohibit the import, trade, possession or proliferation of invasive alien species under the applicable provision. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.**

### Q59. Which statement uses Invasive alien species without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. NBWL and NTCA exercise protected-area and tiger-specific roles under their respective provisions; they do not replace the Chief Wildlife Warden or CITES authorities. B. IUCN category assesses extinction risk, Wildlife Protection Act schedules create domestic legal consequences, and CITES regulates international trade; the three systems are related but distinct. C. The amendment empowered the Central Government to regulate or prohibit the import, trade, possession or proliferation of invasive alien species under the applicable provision. D. Routed demands cover old Schedule VI plant implications, protected-animal provisions and a 2024 Indian Flying Fox vermin question; each must be answered at its legal time point without inferring an option key.

**Answer: C. Explanation: The amendment empowered the Central Government to regulate or prohibit the import, trade, possession or proliferation of invasive alien species under the applicable provision. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.**

### Q60. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Invasive alien species?

A. IUCN category assesses extinction risk, Wildlife Protection Act schedules create domestic legal consequences, and CITES regulates international trade; the three systems are related but distinct. B. Routed demands cover old Schedule VI plant implications, protected-animal provisions and a 2024 Indian Flying Fox vermin question; each must be answered at its legal time point without inferring an option key. C. Every answer must identify whether it uses the pre-2022 six-schedule structure or the post-2022 four-schedule structure of the Wildlife Protection Act. D. The amendment empowered the Central Government to regulate or prohibit the import, trade, possession or proliferation of invasive alien species under the applicable provision.

**Answer: D. Explanation: The amendment empowered the Central Government to regulate or prohibit the import, trade, possession or proliferation of invasive alien species under the applicable provision. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.**

### Q61. Which statement correctly identifies WCCB statutory role?

A. MoEFCC's retrievable page states that WCCB was constituted under section 38Y and lists section 38Z functions including intelligence, coordination, capacity and international cooperation. B. State wildlife departments and the Chief Wildlife Warden perform on-ground authorisation and enforcement functions; their jurisdiction must not be assigned to WCCB. C. NBWL and NTCA exercise protected-area and tiger-specific roles under their respective provisions; they do not replace the Chief Wildlife Warden or CITES authorities. D. IUCN category assesses extinction risk, Wildlife Protection Act schedules create domestic legal consequences, and CITES regulates international trade; the three systems are related but distinct.

**Answer: A. Explanation: MoEFCC's retrievable page states that WCCB was constituted under section 38Y and lists section 38Z functions including intelligence, coordination, capacity and international cooperation. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.**

### Q62. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of WCCB statutory role?

A. NBWL and NTCA exercise protected-area and tiger-specific roles under their respective provisions; they do not replace the Chief Wildlife Warden or CITES authorities. B. MoEFCC's retrievable page states that WCCB was constituted under section 38Y and lists section 38Z functions including intelligence, coordination, capacity and international cooperation. C. IUCN category assesses extinction risk, Wildlife Protection Act schedules create domestic legal consequences, and CITES regulates international trade; the three systems are related but distinct. D. Routed demands cover old Schedule VI plant implications, protected-animal provisions and a 2024 Indian Flying Fox vermin question; each must be answered at its legal time point without inferring an option key.

**Answer: B. Explanation: MoEFCC's retrievable page states that WCCB was constituted under section 38Y and lists section 38Z functions including intelligence, coordination, capacity and international cooperation. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.**

### Q63. Which statement uses WCCB statutory role without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. IUCN category assesses extinction risk, Wildlife Protection Act schedules create domestic legal consequences, and CITES regulates international trade; the three systems are related but distinct. B. Routed demands cover old Schedule VI plant implications, protected-animal provisions and a 2024 Indian Flying Fox vermin question; each must be answered at its legal time point without inferring an option key. C. MoEFCC's retrievable page states that WCCB was constituted under section 38Y and lists section 38Z functions including intelligence, coordination, capacity and international cooperation. D. Every answer must identify whether it uses the pre-2022 six-schedule structure or the post-2022 four-schedule structure of the Wildlife Protection Act.

**Answer: C. Explanation: MoEFCC's retrievable page states that WCCB was constituted under section 38Y and lists section 38Z functions including intelligence, coordination, capacity and international cooperation. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.**

### Q64. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about WCCB statutory role?

A. Routed demands cover old Schedule VI plant implications, protected-animal provisions and a 2024 Indian Flying Fox vermin question; each must be answered at its legal time point without inferring an option key. B. Every answer must identify whether it uses the pre-2022 six-schedule structure or the post-2022 four-schedule structure of the Wildlife Protection Act. C. The Wildlife Protection Amendment Act 2022 restructured the earlier six schedules into four; an older PYQ may still test the law in force at its own time point. D. MoEFCC's retrievable page states that WCCB was constituted under section 38Y and lists section 38Z functions including intelligence, coordination, capacity and international cooperation.

**Answer: D. Explanation: MoEFCC's retrievable page states that WCCB was constituted under section 38Y and lists section 38Z functions including intelligence, coordination, capacity and international cooperation. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.**



### Q65. Which statement correctly identifies State and Chief Wildlife Warden?

A. State wildlife departments and the Chief Wildlife Warden perform on-ground authorisation and enforcement functions; their jurisdiction must not be assigned to WCCB. B. NBWL and NTCA exercise protected-area and tiger-specific roles under their respective provisions; they do not replace the Chief Wildlife Warden or CITES authorities. C. IUCN category assesses extinction risk, Wildlife Protection Act schedules create domestic legal consequences, and CITES regulates international trade; the three systems are related but distinct. D. Routed demands cover old Schedule VI plant implications, protected-animal provisions and a 2024 Indian Flying Fox vermin question; each must be answered at its legal time point without inferring an option key.

**Answer: A. Explanation: State wildlife departments and the Chief Wildlife Warden perform on-ground authorisation and enforcement functions; their jurisdiction must not be assigned to WCCB. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.**

### Q66. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of State and Chief Wildlife Warden?

A. IUCN category assesses extinction risk, Wildlife Protection Act schedules create domestic legal consequences, and CITES regulates international trade; the three systems are related but distinct. B. State wildlife departments and the Chief Wildlife Warden perform on-ground authorisation and enforcement functions; their jurisdiction must not be assigned to WCCB. C. Routed demands cover old Schedule VI plant implications, protected-animal provisions and a 2024 Indian Flying Fox vermin question; each must be answered at its legal time point without inferring an option key. D. Every answer must identify whether it uses the pre-2022 six-schedule structure or the post-2022 four-schedule structure of the Wildlife Protection Act.

**Answer: B. Explanation: State wildlife departments and the Chief Wildlife Warden perform on-ground authorisation and enforcement functions; their jurisdiction must not be assigned to WCCB. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.**

### Q67. Which statement uses State and Chief Wildlife Warden without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Routed demands cover old Schedule VI plant implications, protected-animal provisions and a 2024 Indian Flying Fox vermin question; each must be answered at its legal time point without inferring an option key. B. Every answer must identify whether it uses the pre-2022 six-schedule structure or the post-2022 four-schedule structure of the Wildlife Protection Act. C. State wildlife departments and the Chief Wildlife Warden perform on-ground authorisation and enforcement functions; their jurisdiction must not be assigned to WCCB. D. The Wildlife Protection Amendment Act 2022 restructured the earlier six schedules into four; an older PYQ may still test the law in force at its own time point.

**Answer: C. Explanation: State wildlife departments and the Chief Wildlife Warden perform on-ground authorisation and enforcement functions; their jurisdiction must not be assigned to WCCB. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.**

### Q68. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about State and Chief Wildlife Warden?

A. Every answer must identify whether it uses the pre-2022 six-schedule structure or the post-2022 four-schedule structure of the Wildlife Protection Act. B. The Wildlife Protection Amendment Act 2022 restructured the earlier six schedules into four; an older PYQ may still test the law in force at its own time point. C. Under the post-2022 owner framework, Schedule I lists animals receiving the greatest degree of protection; no species placement is assumed without the current schedule. D. State wildlife departments and the Chief Wildlife Warden perform on-ground authorisation and enforcement functions; their jurisdiction must not be assigned to WCCB.

**Answer: D. Explanation: State wildlife departments and the Chief Wildlife Warden perform on-ground authorisation and enforcement functions; their jurisdiction must not be assigned to WCCB. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.**



### Q69. Which statement correctly identifies NBWL and NTCA?

A. NBWL and NTCA exercise protected-area and tiger-specific roles under their respective provisions; they do not replace the Chief Wildlife Warden or CITES authorities. B. IUCN category assesses extinction risk, Wildlife Protection Act schedules create domestic legal consequences, and CITES regulates international trade; the three systems are related but distinct. C. Routed demands cover old Schedule VI plant implications, protected-animal provisions and a 2024 Indian Flying Fox vermin question; each must be answered at its legal time point without inferring an option key. D. Every answer must identify whether it uses the pre-2022 six-schedule structure or the post-2022 four-schedule structure of the Wildlife Protection Act.

**Answer: A. Explanation: NBWL and NTCA exercise protected-area and tiger-specific roles under their respective provisions; they do not replace the Chief Wildlife Warden or CITES authorities. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.**

### Q70. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of NBWL and NTCA?

A. Routed demands cover old Schedule VI plant implications, protected-animal provisions and a 2024 Indian Flying Fox vermin question; each must be answered at its legal time point without inferring an option key. B. NBWL and NTCA exercise protected-area and tiger-specific roles under their respective provisions; they do not replace the Chief Wildlife Warden or CITES authorities. C. Every answer must identify whether it uses the pre-2022 six-schedule structure or the post-2022 four-schedule structure of the Wildlife Protection Act. D. The Wildlife Protection Amendment Act 2022 restructured the earlier six schedules into four; an older PYQ may still test the law in force at its own time point.

**Answer: B. Explanation: NBWL and NTCA exercise protected-area and tiger-specific roles under their respective provisions; they do not replace the Chief Wildlife Warden or CITES authorities. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.**

### Q71. Which statement uses NBWL and NTCA without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Every answer must identify whether it uses the pre-2022 six-schedule structure or the post-2022 four-schedule structure of the Wildlife Protection Act. B. The Wildlife Protection Amendment Act 2022 restructured the earlier six schedules into four; an older PYQ may still test the law in force at its own time point. C. NBWL and NTCA exercise protected-area and tiger-specific roles under their respective provisions; they do not replace the Chief Wildlife Warden or CITES authorities. D. Under the post-2022 owner framework, Schedule I lists animals receiving the greatest degree of protection; no species placement is assumed without the current schedule.

**Answer: C. Explanation: NBWL and NTCA exercise protected-area and tiger-specific roles under their respective provisions; they do not replace the Chief Wildlife Warden or CITES authorities. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.**

### Q72. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about NBWL and NTCA?

A. The Wildlife Protection Amendment Act 2022 restructured the earlier six schedules into four; an older PYQ may still test the law in force at its own time point. B. Under the post-2022 owner framework, Schedule I lists animals receiving the greatest degree of protection; no species placement is assumed without the current schedule. C. Schedule II lists animals receiving a lesser degree of protection than Schedule I, while still remaining protected under the Act. D. NBWL and NTCA exercise protected-area and tiger-specific roles under their respective provisions; they do not replace the Chief Wildlife Warden or CITES authorities.

**Answer: D. Explanation: NBWL and NTCA exercise protected-area and tiger-specific roles under their respective provisions; they do not replace the Chief Wildlife Warden or CITES authorities. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.**

### Q73. Which statement correctly identifies Science, law and trade?

A. IUCN category assesses extinction risk, Wildlife Protection Act schedules create domestic legal consequences, and CITES regulates international trade; the three systems are related but distinct. B. Routed demands cover old Schedule VI plant implications, protected-animal provisions and a 2024 Indian Flying Fox vermin question; each must be answered at its legal time point without inferring an option key. C. Every answer must identify whether it uses the pre-2022 six-schedule structure or the post-2022 four-schedule structure of the Wildlife Protection Act. D. The Wildlife Protection Amendment Act 2022 restructured the earlier six schedules into four; an older PYQ may still test the law in force at its own time point.

**Answer: A. Explanation: IUCN category assesses extinction risk, Wildlife Protection Act schedules create domestic legal consequences, and CITES regulates international trade; the three systems are related but distinct. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.**

### Q74. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Science, law and trade?

A. Every answer must identify whether it uses the pre-2022 six-schedule structure or the post-2022 four-schedule structure of the Wildlife Protection Act. B. IUCN category assesses extinction risk, Wildlife Protection Act schedules create domestic legal consequences, and CITES regulates international trade; the three systems are related but distinct. C. The Wildlife Protection Amendment Act 2022 restructured the earlier six schedules into four; an older PYQ may still test the law in force at its own time point. D. Under the post-2022 owner framework, Schedule I lists animals receiving the greatest degree of protection; no species placement is assumed without the current schedule.

**Answer: B. Explanation: IUCN category assesses extinction risk, Wildlife Protection Act schedules create domestic legal consequences, and CITES regulates international trade; the three systems are related but distinct. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.**

### Q75. Which statement uses Science, law and trade without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. The Wildlife Protection Amendment Act 2022 restructured the earlier six schedules into four; an older PYQ may still test the law in force at its own time point. B. Under the post-2022 owner framework, Schedule I lists animals receiving the greatest degree of protection; no species placement is assumed without the current schedule. C. IUCN category assesses extinction risk, Wildlife Protection Act schedules create domestic legal consequences, and CITES regulates international trade; the three systems are related but distinct. D. Schedule II lists animals receiving a lesser degree of protection than Schedule I, while still remaining protected under the Act.

**Answer: C. Explanation: IUCN category assesses extinction risk, Wildlife Protection Act schedules create domestic legal consequences, and CITES regulates international trade; the three systems are related but distinct. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.**

### Q76. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Science, law and trade?

A. Under the post-2022 owner framework, Schedule I lists animals receiving the greatest degree of protection; no species placement is assumed without the current schedule. B. Schedule II lists animals receiving a lesser degree of protection than Schedule I, while still remaining protected under the Act. C. Post-2022 Schedule III is the specified plant schedule; it is not a third animal-protection tier and replaces the function of old Schedule VI. D. IUCN category assesses extinction risk, Wildlife Protection Act schedules create domestic legal consequences, and CITES regulates international trade; the three systems are related but distinct.

**Answer: D. Explanation: IUCN category assesses extinction risk, Wildlife Protection Act schedules create domestic legal consequences, and CITES regulates international trade; the three systems are related but distinct. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.**

### Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Audited PYQ vintage boundary?

A. Routed demands cover old Schedule VI plant implications, protected-animal provisions and a 2024 Indian Flying Fox vermin question; each must be answered at its legal time point without inferring an option key. B. Every answer must identify whether it uses the pre-2022 six-schedule structure or the post-2022 four-schedule structure of the Wildlife Protection Act. C. The Wildlife Protection Amendment Act 2022 restructured the earlier six schedules into four; an older PYQ may still test the law in force at its own time point. D. Under the post-2022 owner framework, Schedule I lists animals receiving the greatest degree of protection; no species placement is assumed without the current schedule.

**Answer: A. Explanation: Routed demands cover old Schedule VI plant implications, protected-animal provisions and a 2024 Indian Flying Fox vermin question; each must be answered at its legal time point without inferring an option key. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.**

**Demand decoding:** The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Audited PYQ vintage boundary?", every clause, exact ecological mechanism and scale, named Indian law or institution, dated treaty/policy status, evidence, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

#### Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

**Introduction and thesis:** The answer must resolve the Environment and Ecology demand in "Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Audited PYQ vintage boundary?".

#### Analytical body:

- 1. Claim and named evidence:** Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Audited PYQ vintage boundary?  
**Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
- 2. Claim and named evidence:** A. Routed demands cover old Schedule VI plant implications, protected-animal provisions and a 2024 Indian Flying Fox vermin question; each must be answered at its legal time point without inferring an option key. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
- 3. Claim and named evidence:** B. Every answer must identify whether it uses the pre-2022 six-schedule structure or the post-2022 four-schedule structure of the Wildlife Protection Act. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
- 4. Claim and named evidence:** C. The Wildlife Protection Amendment Act 2022 restructured the earlier six schedules into four; an older PYQ may still test the law in force at its own time point. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
- 5. Claim and named evidence:** D. Under the post-2022 owner framework, Schedule I lists animals receiving the greatest degree of protection; no species placement is assumed without the current schedule. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

**Counter-position / limit:** A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

**Qualified conclusion:** The answer must resolve the Environment and Ecology demand in "Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Audited PYQ vintage boundary?".

**Executable exam-length answer / compression plan:** For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition -> mechanism/status -> institution/instrument -> implementation -> ecological and social outcome; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for taxon, unit, baseline, date, jurisdiction, exception, causation and residual-risk checks.

**Why this earns marks:** The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves ecological, species, legal, treaty, institutional, climate-unit, pollution-standard and causal distinctions.

**How to improve this answer:** For "Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Audited PYQ vintage boundary?", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact mechanism or distinction, named law/institution/treaty/species, dated status, measurable outcome, implementation constraint and answer-specific qualification.

### Q78. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Audited PYQ vintage boundary?

A. The Wildlife Protection Amendment Act 2022 restructured the earlier six schedules into four; an older PYQ may still test the law in force at its own time point. B. Routed demands cover old Schedule VI plant implications, protected-animal provisions and a 2024 Indian Flying Fox vermin question; each must be answered at its legal time point without inferring an option key. C. Under the post-2022 owner framework, Schedule I lists animals receiving the greatest degree of protection; no species placement is assumed without the current schedule. D. Schedule II lists animals receiving a lesser degree of protection than Schedule I, while still remaining protected under the Act.

**Answer: B. Explanation: Routed demands cover old Schedule VI plant implications, protected-animal provisions and a 2024 Indian Flying Fox vermin question; each must be answered at its legal time point without inferring an option key. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.**

**Demand decoding:** Treat "Q78. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Audited PYQ vintage boundary?" as a taxon, ecological mechanism, legal category, institution, treaty/status, parameter, unit, chronology and source-date problem.

#### Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

**Introduction and thesis:** The answer must resolve the Environment and Ecology demand in "Q78. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Audited PYQ vintage boundary?"

#### Analytical body:

- 1. Claim and named evidence:** Q78. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Audited PYQ vintage boundary? **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
- 2. Claim and named evidence:** A. The Wildlife Protection Amendment Act 2022 restructured the earlier six schedules into four; an older PYQ may still test the law in force at its own time point. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
- 3. Claim and named evidence:** B. Routed demands cover old Schedule VI plant implications, protected-animal provisions and a 2024 Indian Flying Fox vermin question; each must be answered at its legal time point without inferring an option key. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
- 4. Claim and named evidence:** C. Under the post-2022 owner framework, Schedule I lists animals receiving the greatest degree of protection; no species placement is assumed without the current schedule. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

5. **Claim and named evidence:** D. Schedule II lists animals receiving a lesser degree of protection than Schedule I, while still remaining protected under the Act. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

**Counter-position / limit:** A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

**Qualified conclusion:** The answer must resolve the Environment and Ecology demand in "Q78. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Audited PYQ vintage boundary?"

**Executable exam-length answer / compression plan:** Fix the system/taxon and scale; mark stock/flow and unit; identify the competent law, institution or treaty status; test each statement against mechanism, date, jurisdiction and closest exception.

**Why this earns marks:** It prevents ecological categories, species statuses, legal schedules, treaty appendices, standards and policy stages from being conflated.

**How to improve this answer:** For "Q78. Which option preserves the ecological boundary of Audited PYQ vintage boundary?", explain why the closest distractor fails on mechanism, scale, taxon, unit, mandate, legal/treaty status, date or causation.

### Q79. Which statement uses Audited PYQ vintage boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?

A. Under the post-2022 owner framework, Schedule I lists animals receiving the greatest degree of protection; no species placement is assumed without the current schedule. B. Schedule II lists animals receiving a lesser degree of protection than Schedule I, while still remaining protected under the Act. C. Routed demands cover old Schedule VI plant implications, protected-animal provisions and a 2024 Indian Flying Fox vermin question; each must be answered at its legal time point without inferring an option key. D. Post-2022 Schedule III is the specified plant schedule; it is not a third animal-protection tier and replaces the function of old Schedule VI.

**Answer: C. Explanation: Routed demands cover old Schedule VI plant implications, protected-animal provisions and a 2024 Indian Flying Fox vermin question; each must be answered at its legal time point without inferring an option key. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.**

**Demand decoding:** The directive answer requires a direct position on "Q79. Which statement uses Audited PYQ vintage boundary without changing its scale, parameter...", every clause, exact ecological mechanism and scale, named Indian law or institution, dated treaty/policy status, evidence, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

#### Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

**Introduction and thesis:** The answer must resolve the Environment and Ecology demand in "Q79. Which statement uses Audited PYQ vintage boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?"

#### Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Q79. Which statement uses Audited PYQ vintage boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status? **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** A. Under the post-2022 owner framework, Schedule I lists animals receiving the greatest degree of protection; no species placement is assumed without the current schedule. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.



3. **Claim and named evidence:** B. Schedule II lists animals receiving a lesser degree of protection than Schedule I, while still remaining protected under the Act. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** C. Routed demands cover old Schedule VI plant implications, protected-animal provisions and a 2024 Indian Flying Fox vermin question; each must be answered at its legal time point without inferring an option key. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** D. Post-2022 Schedule III is the specified plant schedule; it is not a third animal-protection tier and replaces the function of old Schedule VI. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

**Counter-position / limit:** A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

**Qualified conclusion:** The answer must resolve the Environment and Ecology demand in "Q79. Which statement uses Audited PYQ vintage boundary without changing its scale, parameter or status?".

**Executable exam-length answer / compression plan:** For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition -> mechanism/status -> institution/instrument -> implementation -> ecological and social outcome; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for taxon, unit, baseline, date, jurisdiction, exception, causation and residual-risk checks.

**Why this earns marks:** The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves ecological, species, legal, treaty, institutional, climate-unit, pollution-standard and causal distinctions.

**How to improve this answer:** For "Q79. Which statement uses Audited PYQ vintage boundary without changing its scale, parameter...", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact mechanism or distinction, named law/institution/treaty/species, dated status, measurable outcome, implementation constraint and answer-specific qualification.

### Q80. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Audited PYQ vintage boundary?

A. Schedule II lists animals receiving a lesser degree of protection than Schedule I, while still remaining protected under the Act. B. Post-2022 Schedule III is the specified plant schedule; it is not a third animal-protection tier and replaces the function of old Schedule VI. C. Post-2022 Schedule IV covers CITES-listed scheduled specimens for international trade regulation; it is not a higher protection rung than Schedule I or II. D. Routed demands cover old Schedule VI plant implications, protected-animal provisions and a 2024 Indian Flying Fox vermin question; each must be answered at its legal time point without inferring an option key.

**Answer: D. Explanation:** Routed demands cover old Schedule VI plant implications, protected-animal provisions and a 2024 Indian Flying Fox vermin question; each must be answered at its legal time point without inferring an option key. The other options belong to different ecological levels, parameters, processes, scales, institutions or status categories.



## PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

**Demand decoding:** Treat "Q80. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Audited PYQ vintage..." as a taxon, ecological mechanism, legal category, institution, treaty/status, parameter, unit, chronology and source-date problem.

**Detailed examiner-grade model answer:**

**Introduction and thesis:** The answer must resolve the Environment and Ecology demand in "Q80. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Audited PYQ vintage boundary?".

**Analytical body:**

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Q80. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Audited PYQ vintage boundary? **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** A. Schedule II lists animals receiving a lesser degree of protection than Schedule I, while still remaining protected under the Act. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** B. Post-2022 Schedule III is the specified plant schedule; it is not a third animal-protection tier and replaces the function of old Schedule VI. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** C. Post-2022 Schedule IV covers CITES-listed scheduled specimens for international trade regulation; it is not a higher protection rung than Schedule I or II. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** D. Routed demands cover old Schedule VI plant implications, protected-animal provisions and a 2024 Indian Flying Fox vermin question; each must be answered at its legal time point without inferring an option key. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

**Counter-position / limit:** A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

**Qualified conclusion:** The answer must resolve the Environment and Ecology demand in "Q80. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Audited PYQ vintage boundary?".

**Executable exam-length answer / compression plan:** Fix the system/taxon and scale; mark stock/flow and unit; identify the competent law, institution or treaty status; test each statement against mechanism, date, jurisdiction and closest exception.

**Why this earns marks:** It prevents ecological categories, species statuses, legal schedules, treaty appendices, standards and policy stages from being conflated.

**How to improve this answer:** For "Q80. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Audited PYQ vintage...", explain why the closest distractor fails on mechanism, scale, taxon, unit, mandate, legal/treaty status, date or causation.

## VERIFIED OBJECTIVE-ONLY PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT

Audited ledgers route the 2020 old Schedule VI plant demand, 2022 protected-animal provisions and 2024 Indian Flying Fox vermin framing. They remain answer-free objective demands. The package fixes the legal time point and does not infer a species placement, penalty, notification or option key.

## OWNER PYQ LEDGER EXTRACTS

### 9. PYQ application

- ANALYSIS: Recurring Prelims pattern: identify the correct number of schedules post-2022 and match the CITES-alignment feature to Schedule IV specifically.
- ANALYSIS: Mains linkage: the domestic-law-to-international-obligation alignment (Schedule IV/ CITES) is used to argue for coherent, enforceable wildlife-trade governance.

### Recent PYQ Integration (2024-2025)

**Status:** 2024-2025 question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: \_PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2024-2025.md. **Answer-key rule:** The official 2024-2025 Prelims Set-A keys are present in the repository and CSAT Set-A keys are supplied; even so, no option or answer is recorded or inferred in this integration.

- **Years represented:** 2024
- **Paper(s):** Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 1

| Year | Paper        | Q  | PYQ demand (neutral rendering)                                                 | Directive / format                                                            | Source status                                                                       | Owner requirement                                                         |
|------|--------------|----|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2024 | Prelims GS-I | 20 | Indian Flying Fox 'vermin' category under the Wild Life (Protection) Act, 1972 | Objective question; official Set-A key available locally, answer not inferred | Key available locally (official Set-A answer key present); answer not recorded here | Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions. |

### What this owner must now support

- Indian Flying Fox 'vermin' category under the Wild Life (Protection) Act, 1972

This block integrates the 2024-2025 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 block and does not convert an unkeyed/answer-free objective question into a solved answer.

### Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

**Status:** Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: \_PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2018-2023.md. **Answer-key rule:** The official 2018-2023 Prelims/CSAT keys are not held locally; no option or answer has been inferred.

- **Years represented:** 2020, 2022
- **Paper(s):** Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 2

| Year | Paper        | Q  | PYQ demand (neutral rendering)                                  | Directive / format                                   | Source status                   | Owner requirement                                                         |
|------|--------------|----|-----------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2020 | Prelims GS-I | 81 | Schedule VI Wildlife Protection Act plant species implications  | Objective question; official key unavailable locally | Routed; key unavailable locally | Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions. |
| 2022 | Prelims GS-I | 89 | Indian wildlife protection laws and protected animal provisions | Objective question; official key unavailable locally | Routed; key unavailable locally | Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions. |

### What this owner must now support

- Schedule VI Wildlife Protection Act plant species implications
- Indian wildlife protection laws and protected animal provisions

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

### 10. PYQ-based analytical application

- ANALYSIS: Prelims statement-based questions on the 2022 amendment typically test the schedule-count change and the CITES-alignment feature - apply the "four schedules, Schedule IV mirrors CITES" rule to eliminate incorrect options quickly.
- ANALYSIS: Mains answers should connect the 2022 amendment explicitly to India's CITES compliance narrative (Topic 09) and to enforcement-capacity critique, rather than describing it as an isolated domestic legal change.

### ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS

**Question:** Explain the post-2022 four-schedule structure. Answer in about 150 words.

**Model thesis: Claim:** Legal vintage first. **Named evidence/example:** Every answer must identify whether it uses the pre-2022 six-schedule structure or the post-2022 four-schedule structure of the Wildlife Protection Act. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable.

**Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Six schedules to four. **Named evidence/example:** The Wildlife Protection Amendment Act 2022 restructured the earlier six schedules into four; an older PYQ may still test the law in force at its own time point. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable.

**Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Schedule I.

**Named evidence/example:** Under the post-2022 owner framework, Schedule I lists animals receiving the greatest degree of protection; no species placement is assumed without the current schedule. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable.

**Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Schedule II.

**Named evidence/example:** Schedule II lists animals receiving a lesser degree of protection than Schedule I, while still remaining protected under the Act. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Schedule III. **Named evidence/example:** Post-2022 Schedule III is the specified plant schedule; it is not a third animal-protection tier and replaces the function of old Schedule VI.

**Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Schedule IV. **Named evidence/example:** Post-2022 Schedule IV covers CITES-listed scheduled specimens

for international trade regulation; it is not a higher protection rung than Schedule I or II. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable.

**Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

**Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:**

- Every answer must identify whether it uses the pre-2022 six-schedule structure or the post-2022 four-schedule structure of the Wildlife Protection Act.
- The Wildlife Protection Amendment Act 2022 restructured the earlier six schedules into four; an older PYQ may still test the law in force at its own time point.
- Under the post-2022 owner framework, Schedule I lists animals receiving the greatest degree of protection; no species placement is assumed without the current schedule.
- Schedule II lists animals receiving a lesser degree of protection than Schedule I, while still remaining protected under the Act.
- Post-2022 Schedule III is the specified plant schedule; it is not a third animal-protection tier and replaces the function of old Schedule VI.
- Post-2022 Schedule IV covers CITES-listed scheduled specimens for international trade regulation; it is not a higher protection rung than Schedule I or II.

**Qualified conclusion: Claim:** Legal vintage first. **Named evidence/example:** Every answer must identify whether it uses the pre-2022 six-schedule structure or the post-2022 four-schedule structure of the Wildlife Protection Act.

**Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

**Claim:** Six schedules to four. **Named evidence/example:** The Wildlife Protection Amendment Act 2022 restructured the earlier six schedules into four; an older PYQ may still test the law in force at its own time point. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable.

**Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Schedule I.

**Named evidence/example:** Under the post-2022 owner framework, Schedule I lists animals receiving the greatest degree of protection; no species placement is assumed without the current schedule. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable.

**Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Schedule II.

**Named evidence/example:** Schedule II lists animals receiving a lesser degree of protection than Schedule I, while still remaining protected under the Act. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

**Claim:** Schedule III. **Named evidence/example:** Post-2022 Schedule III is the specified plant schedule; it is not a third animal-protection tier and replaces the function of old Schedule VI. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable.

**Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Schedule IV. **Named evidence/example:** Post-2022 Schedule IV covers CITES-listed scheduled specimens for international trade regulation; it is not a higher protection rung than Schedule I or II. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable.

**Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

**Claim:** Schedule IV. **Named evidence/example:** Post-2022 Schedule IV covers CITES-listed scheduled specimens for international trade regulation; it is not a higher protection rung than Schedule I or II. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable.

**Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

**Demand decoding:** The directive **explain** requires a direct position on "Explain the post-2022 four-schedule structure. Answer in about 150 words.", every clause, exact ecological mechanism and scale, named Indian law or institution, dated treaty/policy status, evidence, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

**Detailed examiner-grade model answer:**

**Introduction and thesis: Claim:** Legal vintage first. **Named evidence/example:** Every answer must identify whether it uses the pre-2022 six-schedule structure or the post-2022 four-schedule structure of the Wildlife Protection Act.

**Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

**Claim:** Six schedules to four. **Named evidence/example:** The Wildlife Protection Amendment Act 2022 restructured the earlier six schedules into four; an older PYQ may still test the law in force at its own time point. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable.

**Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Schedule I.

**Named evidence/example:** Under the post-2022 owner framework, Schedule I lists animals receiving the greatest degree of protection; no species placement is assumed without the current schedule. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable.

**Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Schedule II.

**Named evidence/example:** Schedule II lists animals receiving a lesser degree of protection than Schedule I, while still remaining protected under the Act. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Schedule III. **Named evidence/example:** Post-2022 Schedule III is the specified plant schedule; it is not a third animal-protection tier and replaces the function of old Schedule VI.

**Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

**Claim:** Schedule IV. **Named evidence/example:** Post-2022 Schedule IV covers CITES-listed scheduled specimens for international trade regulation; it is not a higher protection rung than Schedule I or II. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable.

**Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

#### Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Every answer must identify whether it uses the pre-2022 six-schedule structure or the post-2022 four-schedule structure of the Wildlife Protection Act. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** The Wildlife Protection Amendment Act 2022 restructured the earlier six schedules into four; an older PYQ may still test the law in force at its own time point. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Under the post-2022 owner framework, Schedule I lists animals receiving the greatest degree of protection; no species placement is assumed without the current schedule. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Schedule II lists animals receiving a lesser degree of protection than Schedule I, while still remaining protected under the Act. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** Post-2022 Schedule III is the specified plant schedule; it is not a third animal-protection tier and replaces the function of old Schedule VI. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon



and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

6. **Claim and named evidence:** Post-2022 Schedule IV covers CITES-listed scheduled specimens for international trade regulation; it is not a higher protection rung than Schedule I or II. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

**Counter-position / limit:** A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

**Qualified conclusion: Claim:** Legal vintage first. **Named evidence/example:** Every answer must identify whether it uses the pre-2022 six-schedule structure or the post-2022 four-schedule structure of the Wildlife Protection Act.

**Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

**Claim:** Six schedules to four. **Named evidence/example:** The Wildlife Protection Amendment Act 2022 restructured the earlier six schedules into four; an older PYQ may still test the law in force at its own time point. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable.

**Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Schedule I.

**Named evidence/example:** Under the post-2022 owner framework, Schedule I lists animals receiving the greatest degree of protection; no species placement is assumed without the current schedule. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable.

**Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Schedule II.

**Named evidence/example:** Schedule II lists animals receiving a lesser degree of protection than Schedule I, while still remaining protected under the Act. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Schedule III. **Named evidence/example:** Post-2022 Schedule III is the specified plant schedule; it is not a third animal-protection tier and replaces the function of old Schedule VI.

**Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

**Claim:** Schedule IV. **Named evidence/example:** Post-2022 Schedule IV covers CITES-listed scheduled specimens for international trade regulation; it is not a higher protection rung than Schedule I or II. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable.

**Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

**Executable exam-length answer / compression plan:** For 10 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition -> mechanism/status -> institution/instrument -> implementation -> ecological and social outcome; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for taxon, unit, baseline, date, jurisdiction, exception, causation and residual-risk checks.

**Why this earns marks:** The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves ecological, species, legal, treaty, institutional, climate-unit, pollution-standard and causal distinctions.

**How to improve this answer:** For "Explain the post-2022 four-schedule structure. Answer in about 150 words.", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact mechanism or distinction, named law/institution/treaty/species, dated status, measurable outcome, implementation constraint and answer-specific qualification.



## ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS

**Question:** Distinguish Schedule IV trade control from animal protection tiers. Answer in about 150 words.

**Model thesis:** **Claim:** Schedule I. **Named evidence/example:** Under the post-2022 owner framework, Schedule I lists animals receiving the greatest degree of protection; no species placement is assumed without the current schedule. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Schedule II. **Named evidence/example:** Schedule II lists animals receiving a lesser degree of protection than Schedule I, while still remaining protected under the Act. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Schedule IV. **Named evidence/example:** Post-2022 Schedule IV covers CITES-listed scheduled specimens for international trade regulation; it is not a higher protection rung than Schedule I or II. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Science, law and trade. **Named evidence/example:** IUCN category assesses extinction risk, Wildlife Protection Act schedules create domestic legal consequences, and CITES regulates international trade; the three systems are related but distinct. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

**Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:**

- Under the post-2022 owner framework, Schedule I lists animals receiving the greatest degree of protection; no species placement is assumed without the current schedule.
- Schedule II lists animals receiving a lesser degree of protection than Schedule I, while still remaining protected under the Act.
- Post-2022 Schedule IV covers CITES-listed scheduled specimens for international trade regulation; it is not a higher protection rung than Schedule I or II.
- IUCN category assesses extinction risk, Wildlife Protection Act schedules create domestic legal consequences, and CITES regulates international trade; the three systems are related but distinct.

**Qualified conclusion:** **Claim:** Schedule I. **Named evidence/example:** Under the post-2022 owner framework, Schedule I lists animals receiving the greatest degree of protection; no species placement is assumed without the current schedule. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Schedule II. **Named evidence/example:** Schedule II lists animals receiving a lesser degree of protection than Schedule I, while still remaining protected under the Act. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Schedule IV. **Named evidence/example:** Post-2022 Schedule IV covers CITES-listed scheduled specimens for international trade regulation; it is not a higher protection rung than Schedule I or II. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Science, law and trade. **Named evidence/example:** IUCN category assesses extinction risk, Wildlife Protection Act schedules create domestic legal consequences, and CITES regulates international trade; the three systems are related but distinct. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

**Demand decoding:** The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "Distinguish Schedule IV trade control from animal protection tiers. Answer in about 150 words.", every clause, exact ecological mechanism and scale, named Indian law or institution, dated treaty/policy status, evidence, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

**Detailed examiner-grade model answer:**

**Introduction and thesis:** **Claim:** Schedule I. **Named evidence/example:** Under the post-2022 owner framework, Schedule I lists animals receiving the greatest degree of protection; no species placement is assumed without the current schedule. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Schedule II. **Named evidence/example:** Schedule II lists animals receiving a lesser degree of protection than Schedule I, while still remaining protected under the Act. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Schedule IV. **Named evidence/example:** Post-2022 Schedule IV covers CITES-listed scheduled specimens for international trade regulation; it is not a higher protection rung than Schedule I or II. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Science, law and trade. **Named evidence/example:** IUCN category assesses extinction risk, Wildlife Protection Act schedules create domestic legal consequences, and CITES regulates international trade; the three systems are related but distinct. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

**Analytical body:**

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Under the post-2022 owner framework, Schedule I lists animals receiving the greatest degree of protection; no species placement is assumed without the current schedule. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Schedule II lists animals receiving a lesser degree of protection than Schedule I, while still remaining protected under the Act. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Post-2022 Schedule IV covers CITES-listed scheduled specimens for international trade regulation; it is not a higher protection rung than Schedule I or II. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** IUCN category assesses extinction risk, Wildlife Protection Act schedules create domestic legal consequences, and CITES regulates international trade; the three systems are related but distinct. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

**Counter-position / limit:** A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

**Qualified conclusion:** **Claim:** Schedule I. **Named evidence/example:** Under the post-2022 owner framework, Schedule I lists animals receiving the greatest degree of protection; no species placement is assumed without the current schedule. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link

that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Schedule II. **Named evidence/example:** Schedule II lists animals receiving a lesser degree of protection than Schedule I, while still remaining protected under the Act. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable.

**Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Schedule IV. **Named evidence/example:** Post-2022 Schedule IV covers CITES-listed scheduled specimens for international trade regulation; it is not a higher protection rung than Schedule I or II. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Science, law and trade. **Named evidence/example:** IUCN category assesses extinction risk, Wildlife Protection Act schedules create domestic legal consequences, and CITES regulates international trade; the three systems are related but distinct. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

**Executable exam-length answer / compression plan:** For 10 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition -> mechanism/status -> institution/instrument -> implementation -> ecological and social outcome; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for taxon, unit, baseline, date, jurisdiction, exception, causation and residual-risk checks.

**Why this earns marks:** The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves ecological, species, legal, treaty, institutional, climate-unit, pollution-standard and causal distinctions.

**How to improve this answer:** For "Distinguish Schedule IV trade control from animal protection tiers. Answer in about 150 words.", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact mechanism or distinction, named law/institution/treaty/species, dated status, measurable outcome, implementation constraint and answer-specific qualification.

### ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS

**Question:** Explain hunting prohibition and narrow statutory exceptions. Answer in about 250 words.

**Model thesis:** **Claim:** Hunting prohibition. **Named evidence/example:** The Act's baseline is prohibition of hunting protected wild animals; a legal exception must be traced to its statutory condition, authority and written permission. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Permit and exception. **Named evidence/example:** Scientific, educational, collection or management purposes do not create a free-standing right to hunt; the applicable permit and statutory conditions remain necessary. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Dangerous or beyond recovery route. **Named evidence/example:** The owner records narrow action where an animal is dangerous to human life or disabled or diseased beyond recovery, with the competent authority depending on schedule and provision. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** State and Chief Wildlife Warden. **Named evidence/example:** State wildlife departments and the Chief Wildlife Warden perform on-ground authorisation and enforcement functions; their jurisdiction must not be assigned to WCCB. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

### Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The Act's baseline is prohibition of hunting protected wild animals; a legal exception must be traced to its statutory condition, authority and written permission.
- Scientific, educational, collection or management purposes do not create a free-standing right to hunt; the applicable permit and statutory conditions remain necessary.
- The owner records narrow action where an animal is dangerous to human life or disabled or diseased beyond recovery, with the competent authority depending on schedule and provision.
- State wildlife departments and the Chief Wildlife Warden perform on-ground authorisation and enforcement functions; their jurisdiction must not be assigned to WCCB.

**Qualified conclusion: Claim:** Hunting prohibition. **Named evidence/example:** The Act's baseline is prohibition of hunting protected wild animals; a legal exception must be traced to its statutory condition, authority and written permission. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Permit and exception. **Named evidence/example:** Scientific, educational, collection or management purposes do not create a free-standing right to hunt; the applicable permit and statutory conditions remain necessary. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Dangerous or beyond recovery route. **Named evidence/example:** The owner records narrow action where an animal is dangerous to human life or disabled or diseased beyond recovery, with the competent authority depending on schedule and provision. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** State and Chief Wildlife Warden. **Named evidence/example:** State wildlife departments and the Chief Wildlife Warden perform on-ground authorisation and enforcement functions; their jurisdiction must not be assigned to WCCB. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

**Demand decoding:** The directive **explain** requires a direct position on "Explain hunting prohibition and narrow statutory exceptions. Answer in about 250 words.", every clause, exact ecological mechanism and scale, named Indian law or institution, dated treaty/policy status, evidence, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

### Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

**Introduction and thesis: Claim:** Hunting prohibition. **Named evidence/example:** The Act's baseline is prohibition of hunting protected wild animals; a legal exception must be traced to its statutory condition, authority and written permission. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Permit and exception. **Named evidence/example:** Scientific, educational, collection or management purposes do not create a free-standing right to hunt; the applicable permit and statutory conditions remain necessary. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Dangerous or beyond recovery route. **Named evidence/example:** The owner records narrow action where an animal is dangerous to human life or disabled or diseased beyond recovery, with the competent authority depending on schedule and provision. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** State and Chief Wildlife Warden. **Named evidence/example:** State wildlife departments and the Chief Wildlife Warden perform on-ground authorisation and enforcement functions; their



jurisdiction must not be assigned to WCCB. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

#### Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The Act's baseline is prohibition of hunting protected wild animals; a legal exception must be traced to its statutory condition, authority and written permission. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Scientific, educational, collection or management purposes do not create a free-standing right to hunt; the applicable permit and statutory conditions remain necessary. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** The owner records narrow action where an animal is dangerous to human life or disabled or diseased beyond recovery, with the competent authority depending on schedule and provision. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** State wildlife departments and the Chief Wildlife Warden perform on-ground authorisation and enforcement functions; their jurisdiction must not be assigned to WCCB. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

**Counter-position / limit:** A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

**Qualified conclusion: Claim:** Hunting prohibition. **Named evidence/example:** The Act's baseline is prohibition of hunting protected wild animals; a legal exception must be traced to its statutory condition, authority and written permission. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Permit and exception. **Named evidence/example:** Scientific, educational, collection or management purposes do not create a free-standing right to hunt; the applicable permit and statutory conditions remain necessary. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Dangerous or beyond recovery route. **Named evidence/example:** The owner records narrow action where an animal is dangerous to human life or disabled or diseased beyond recovery, with the competent authority depending on schedule and provision. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** State and Chief Wildlife Warden. **Named evidence/example:** State wildlife departments and the Chief Wildlife Warden perform on-ground authorisation and enforcement functions; their jurisdiction must not be assigned to WCCB. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

**Executable exam-length answer / compression plan:** For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition -> mechanism/status -> institution/instrument -> implementation -> ecological and

social outcome; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for taxon, unit, baseline, date, jurisdiction, exception, causation and residual-risk checks.

**Why this earns marks:** The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves ecological, species, legal, treaty, institutional, climate-unit, pollution-standard and causal distinctions.

**How to improve this answer:** For "Explain hunting prohibition and narrow statutory exceptions. Answer in about 250 words.", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact mechanism or distinction, named law/institution/treaty/species, dated status, measurable outcome, implementation constraint and answer-specific qualification.

## ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS

**Question:** Explain CITES alignment through Schedule IV and the two authorities. Answer in about 250 words.

**Model thesis: Claim:** Schedule IV. **Named evidence/example:** Post-2022 Schedule IV covers CITES-listed scheduled specimens for international trade regulation; it is not a higher protection rung than Schedule I or II.

**Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

**Claim:** CITES Management Authority. **Named evidence/example:** The post-2022 framework requires a Management Authority for permits and certificates in international trade in scheduled specimens. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable.

**Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** CITES

Scientific Authority. **Named evidence/example:** The Scientific Authority advises on the conservation consequences of trade; it performs a different function from the permit-issuing Management Authority. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable.

**Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Chapter VB trade architecture. **Named evidence/example:** The 2022 amendment inserted a dedicated international-trade chapter for scheduled specimens, translating CITES obligations into domestic legal machinery. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable.

**Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

**Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:**

- Post-2022 Schedule IV covers CITES-listed scheduled specimens for international trade regulation; it is not a higher protection rung than Schedule I or II.
- The post-2022 framework requires a Management Authority for permits and certificates in international trade in scheduled specimens.
- The Scientific Authority advises on the conservation consequences of trade; it performs a different function from the permit-issuing Management Authority.
- The 2022 amendment inserted a dedicated international-trade chapter for scheduled specimens, translating CITES obligations into domestic legal machinery.

**Qualified conclusion: Claim:** Schedule IV. **Named evidence/example:** Post-2022 Schedule IV covers CITES-listed scheduled specimens for international trade regulation; it is not a higher protection rung than Schedule I or II.

**Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

**Claim:** CITES Management Authority. **Named evidence/example:** The post-2022 framework requires a Management Authority for permits and certificates in international trade in scheduled specimens. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable.

**Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** CITES



Scientific Authority. **Named evidence/example:** The Scientific Authority advises on the conservation consequences of trade; it performs a different function from the permit-issuing Management Authority. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable.

**Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Chapter VB trade architecture. **Named evidence/example:** The 2022 amendment inserted a dedicated international-trade chapter for scheduled specimens, translating CITES obligations into domestic legal machinery. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable.

**Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

**Demand decoding:** The directive **explain** requires a direct position on "Explain CITES alignment through Schedule IV and the two authorities. Answer in about 250...", every clause, exact ecological mechanism and scale, named Indian law or institution, dated treaty/policy status, evidence, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

#### **Detailed examiner-grade model answer:**

**Introduction and thesis: Claim:** Schedule IV. **Named evidence/example:** Post-2022 Schedule IV covers CITES-listed scheduled specimens for international trade regulation; it is not a higher protection rung than Schedule I or II. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** CITES Management Authority. **Named evidence/example:** The post-2022 framework requires a Management Authority for permits and certificates in international trade in scheduled specimens. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** CITES Scientific Authority. **Named evidence/example:** The Scientific Authority advises on the conservation consequences of trade; it performs a different function from the permit-issuing Management Authority. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Chapter VB trade architecture. **Named evidence/example:** The 2022 amendment inserted a dedicated international-trade chapter for scheduled specimens, translating CITES obligations into domestic legal machinery. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

#### **Analytical body:**

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Post-2022 Schedule IV covers CITES-listed scheduled specimens for international trade regulation; it is not a higher protection rung than Schedule I or II. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** The post-2022 framework requires a Management Authority for permits and certificates in international trade in scheduled specimens. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** The Scientific Authority advises on the conservation consequences of trade; it performs a different function from the permit-issuing Management Authority. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

4. **Claim and named evidence:** The 2022 amendment inserted a dedicated international-trade chapter for scheduled specimens, translating CITES obligations into domestic legal machinery. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

**Counter-position / limit:** A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

**Qualified conclusion: Claim:** Schedule IV. **Named evidence/example:** Post-2022 Schedule IV covers CITES-listed scheduled specimens for international trade regulation; it is not a higher protection rung than Schedule I or II.

**Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

**Claim:** CITES Management Authority. **Named evidence/example:** The post-2022 framework requires a Management Authority for permits and certificates in international trade in scheduled specimens. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable.

**Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** CITES Scientific Authority. **Named evidence/example:** The Scientific Authority advises on the conservation consequences of trade; it performs a different function from the permit-issuing Management Authority. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable.

**Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Chapter VB trade architecture. **Named evidence/example:** The 2022 amendment inserted a dedicated international-trade chapter for scheduled specimens, translating CITES obligations into domestic legal machinery. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable.

**Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

**Executable exam-length answer / compression plan:** For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition -> mechanism/status -> institution/instrument -> implementation -> ecological and social outcome; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for taxon, unit, baseline, date, jurisdiction, exception, causation and residual-risk checks.

**Why this earns marks:** The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves ecological, species, legal, treaty, institutional, climate-unit, pollution-standard and causal distinctions.

**How to improve this answer:** For "Explain CITES alignment through Schedule IV and the two authorities. Answer in about 250...", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact mechanism or distinction, named law/institution/treaty/species, dated status, measurable outcome, implementation constraint and answer-specific qualification.

## ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS

**Question:** Assess the 2022 amendment as treaty-alignment and enforcement reform. Answer in about 300 words.

**Model thesis: Claim:** Six schedules to four. **Named evidence/example:** The Wildlife Protection Amendment Act 2022 restructured the earlier six schedules into four; an older PYQ may still test the law in force at its own time point.

**Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

**Claim:** Species placement discipline. **Named evidence/example:** Exact species-to-schedule placement can change through the applicable legal process and must be checked against the current consolidated schedule or notification.

**Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial

scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

**Claim:** Chapter VB trade architecture. **Named evidence/example:** The 2022 amendment inserted a dedicated international-trade chapter for scheduled specimens, translating CITES obligations into domestic legal machinery.

**Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

**Claim:** Invasive alien species. **Named evidence/example:** The amendment empowered the Central Government to regulate or prohibit the import, trade, possession or proliferation of invasive alien species under the applicable provision. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

**Claim:** WCCB statutory role. **Named evidence/example:** MoEFCC's retrievable page states that WCCB was constituted under section 38Y and lists section 38Z functions including intelligence, coordination, capacity and international cooperation. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** NBWL and NTCA. **Named evidence/example:** NBWL and NTCA exercise protected-area and tiger-specific roles under their respective provisions; they do not replace the Chief Wildlife Warden or CITES authorities. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

**Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:**

- The Wildlife Protection Amendment Act 2022 restructured the earlier six schedules into four; an older PYQ may still test the law in force at its own time point.
- Exact species-to-schedule placement can change through the applicable legal process and must be checked against the current consolidated schedule or notification.
- The 2022 amendment inserted a dedicated international-trade chapter for scheduled specimens, translating CITES obligations into domestic legal machinery.
- The amendment empowered the Central Government to regulate or prohibit the import, trade, possession or proliferation of invasive alien species under the applicable provision.
- MoEFCC's retrievable page states that WCCB was constituted under section 38Y and lists section 38Z functions including intelligence, coordination, capacity and international cooperation.
- NBWL and NTCA exercise protected-area and tiger-specific roles under their respective provisions; they do not replace the Chief Wildlife Warden or CITES authorities.

**Qualified conclusion: Claim:** Six schedules to four. **Named evidence/example:** The Wildlife Protection Amendment Act 2022 restructured the earlier six schedules into four; an older PYQ may still test the law in force at its own time point. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

**Claim:** Species placement discipline. **Named evidence/example:** Exact species-to-schedule placement can change through the applicable legal process and must be checked against the current consolidated schedule or notification.

**Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

**Claim:** Chapter VB trade architecture. **Named evidence/example:** The 2022 amendment inserted a dedicated international-trade chapter for scheduled specimens, translating CITES obligations into domestic legal machinery.

**Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

**Claim:** Invasive alien species. **Named evidence/example:** The amendment empowered the Central Government to

regulate or prohibit the import, trade, possession or proliferation of invasive alien species under the applicable provision. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** WCCB statutory role. **Named evidence/example:** MoEFCC's retrievable page states that WCCB was constituted under section 38Y and lists section 38Z functions including intelligence, coordination, capacity and international cooperation. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** NBWL and NTCA. **Named evidence/example:** NBWL and NTCA exercise protected-area and tiger-specific roles under their respective provisions; they do not replace the Chief Wildlife Warden or CITES authorities. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

**Demand decoding:** The directive **assess** requires a direct position on "Assess the 2022 amendment as treaty-alignment and enforcement reform. Answer in about 300...", every clause, exact ecological mechanism and scale, named Indian law or institution, dated treaty/policy status, evidence, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

#### **Detailed examiner-grade model answer:**

**Introduction and thesis:** **Claim:** Six schedules to four. **Named evidence/example:** The Wildlife Protection Amendment Act 2022 restructured the earlier six schedules into four; an older PYQ may still test the law in force at its own time point. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Species placement discipline. **Named evidence/example:** Exact species-to-schedule placement can change through the applicable legal process and must be checked against the current consolidated schedule or notification. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Chapter VB trade architecture. **Named evidence/example:** The 2022 amendment inserted a dedicated international-trade chapter for scheduled specimens, translating CITES obligations into domestic legal machinery. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Invasive alien species. **Named evidence/example:** The amendment empowered the Central Government to regulate or prohibit the import, trade, possession or proliferation of invasive alien species under the applicable provision. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** WCCB statutory role. **Named evidence/example:** MoEFCC's retrievable page states that WCCB was constituted under section 38Y and lists section 38Z functions including intelligence, coordination, capacity and international cooperation. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** NBWL and NTCA. **Named evidence/example:** NBWL and NTCA exercise protected-area and tiger-specific roles under their respective provisions; they do not replace the Chief Wildlife Warden or CITES authorities. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

#### **Analytical body:**



1. **Claim and named evidence:** The Wildlife Protection Amendment Act 2022 restructured the earlier six schedules into four; an older PYQ may still test the law in force at its own time point. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Exact species-to-schedule placement can change through the applicable legal process and must be checked against the current consolidated schedule or notification. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** The 2022 amendment inserted a dedicated international-trade chapter for scheduled specimens, translating CITES obligations into domestic legal machinery. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** The amendment empowered the Central Government to regulate or prohibit the import, trade, possession or proliferation of invasive alien species under the applicable provision. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** MoEFCC's retrievable page states that WCCB was constituted under section 38Y and lists section 38Z functions including intelligence, coordination, capacity and international cooperation. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
6. **Claim and named evidence:** NBWL and NTCA exercise protected-area and tiger-specific roles under their respective provisions; they do not replace the Chief Wildlife Warden or CITES authorities. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

**Counter-position / limit:** A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

**Qualified conclusion: Claim:** Six schedules to four. **Named evidence/example:** The Wildlife Protection Amendment Act 2022 restructured the earlier six schedules into four; an older PYQ may still test the law in force at its own time point. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Species placement discipline. **Named evidence/example:** Exact species-to-schedule placement can change through the applicable legal process and must be checked against the current consolidated schedule or notification. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Chapter VB trade architecture. **Named evidence/example:** The 2022 amendment inserted a dedicated international-trade chapter for scheduled specimens, translating CITES obligations into domestic legal machinery. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Invasive alien species. **Named evidence/example:** The amendment empowered the Central Government to regulate or prohibit the import, trade, possession or proliferation of invasive alien species under the applicable provision. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter,



spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** WCCB statutory role. **Named evidence/example:** MoEFCC's retrievable page states that WCCB was constituted under section 38Y and lists section 38Z functions including intelligence, coordination, capacity and international cooperation. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** NBWL and NTCA. **Named evidence/example:** NBWL and NTCA exercise protected-area and tiger-specific roles under their respective provisions; they do not replace the Chief Wildlife Warden or CITES authorities. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

**Executable exam-length answer / compression plan:** For 20 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition -> mechanism/status -> institution/instrument -> implementation -> ecological and social outcome; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for taxon, unit, baseline, date, jurisdiction, exception, causation and residual-risk checks.

**Why this earns marks:** The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves ecological, species, legal, treaty, institutional, climate-unit, pollution-standard and causal distinctions.

**How to improve this answer:** For "Assess the 2022 amendment as treaty-alignment and enforcement reform. Answer in about 300...", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact mechanism or distinction, named law/institution/treaty/species, dated status, measurable outcome, implementation constraint and answer-specific qualification.

## ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS

**Question:** Why must wildlife-law answers be time-sensitive and jurisdiction-specific? Answer in about 300 words.

**Model thesis:** **Claim:** Legal vintage first. **Named evidence/example:** Every answer must identify whether it uses the pre-2022 six-schedule structure or the post-2022 four-schedule structure of the Wildlife Protection Act. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Species placement discipline. **Named evidence/example:** Exact species-to-schedule placement can change through the applicable legal process and must be checked against the current consolidated schedule or notification. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Vermin time point. **Named evidence/example:** The old Schedule V vermin list was omitted in 2022; the owner records a central notification route for a specified area and period and excludes Schedule I animals. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** State and Chief Wildlife Warden. **Named evidence/example:** State wildlife departments and the Chief Wildlife Warden perform on-ground authorisation and enforcement functions; their jurisdiction must not be assigned to WCCB. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Science, law and trade. **Named evidence/example:** IUCN category assesses extinction risk, Wildlife Protection Act schedules create domestic legal consequences, and CITES regulates international trade; the three systems are related but distinct. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Audited PYQ vintage boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Routed demands cover old Schedule VI

plant implications, protected-animal provisions and a 2024 Indian Flying Fox vermin question; each must be answered at its legal time point without inferring an option key. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

**Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:**

- Every answer must identify whether it uses the pre-2022 six-schedule structure or the post-2022 four-schedule structure of the Wildlife Protection Act.
- Exact species-to-schedule placement can change through the applicable legal process and must be checked against the current consolidated schedule or notification.
- The old Schedule V vermin list was omitted in 2022; the owner records a central notification route for a specified area and period and excludes Schedule I animals.
- State wildlife departments and the Chief Wildlife Warden perform on-ground authorisation and enforcement functions; their jurisdiction must not be assigned to WCCB.
- IUCN category assesses extinction risk, Wildlife Protection Act schedules create domestic legal consequences, and CITES regulates international trade; the three systems are related but distinct.
- Routed demands cover old Schedule VI plant implications, protected-animal provisions and a 2024 Indian Flying Fox vermin question; each must be answered at its legal time point without inferring an option key.

**Qualified conclusion: Claim:** Legal vintage first. **Named evidence/example:** Every answer must identify whether it uses the pre-2022 six-schedule structure or the post-2022 four-schedule structure of the Wildlife Protection Act.

**Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

**Claim:** Species placement discipline. **Named evidence/example:** Exact species-to-schedule placement can change through the applicable legal process and must be checked against the current consolidated schedule or notification.

**Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

**Claim:** Vermin time point. **Named evidence/example:** The old Schedule V vermin list was omitted in 2022; the owner records a central notification route for a specified area and period and excludes Schedule I animals. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable.

**Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** State and Chief Wildlife Warden. **Named evidence/example:** State wildlife departments and the Chief Wildlife Warden perform on-ground authorisation and enforcement functions; their jurisdiction must not be assigned to WCCB. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable.

**Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Science, law and trade. **Named evidence/example:** IUCN category assesses extinction risk, Wildlife Protection Act schedules create domestic legal consequences, and CITES regulates international trade; the three systems are related but distinct. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Audited PYQ vintage boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Routed demands cover old Schedule VI plant implications, protected-animal provisions and a 2024 Indian Flying Fox vermin question; each must be answered at its legal time point without inferring an option key. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

**Demand decoding:** The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "Why must wildlife-law answers be time-sensitive and jurisdiction-specific? Answer in about...", every clause, exact ecological mechanism and scale,

named Indian law or institution, dated treaty/policy status, evidence, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

**Detailed examiner-grade model answer:**

**Introduction and thesis: Claim:** Legal vintage first. **Named evidence/example:** Every answer must identify whether it uses the pre-2022 six-schedule structure or the post-2022 four-schedule structure of the Wildlife Protection Act.

**Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

**Claim:** Species placement discipline. **Named evidence/example:** Exact species-to-schedule placement can change through the applicable legal process and must be checked against the current consolidated schedule or notification.

**Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

**Claim:** Vermin time point. **Named evidence/example:** The old Schedule V vermin list was omitted in 2022; the owner records a central notification route for a specified area and period and excludes Schedule I animals. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable.

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**Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Science, law and trade. **Named evidence/example:** IUCN category assesses extinction risk, Wildlife Protection Act schedules create domestic legal consequences, and CITES regulates international trade; the three systems are related but distinct. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner. **Claim:** Audited PYQ vintage boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Routed demands cover old Schedule VI plant implications, protected-animal provisions and a 2024 Indian Flying Fox vermin question; each must be answered at its legal time point without inferring an option key. **Analysis:** This identifies the ecological mechanism, system boundary, state variable and causal link that make the claim examinable. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the source's ecosystem, trophic parameter, spatial scale, temporal stage, taxonomic level, legal status and evidence boundary rather than generalise beyond the owner.

**Analytical body:**

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Every answer must identify whether it uses the pre-2022 six-schedule structure or the post-2022 four-schedule structure of the Wildlife Protection Act. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Exact species-to-schedule placement can change through the applicable legal process and must be checked against the current consolidated schedule or notification. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** The old Schedule V vermin list was omitted in 2022; the owner records a central notification route for a specified area and period and excludes Schedule I animals. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** State wildlife departments and the Chief Wildlife Warden perform on-ground authorisation and enforcement functions; their jurisdiction must not be assigned to WCCB. **Analysis:** Connect the

defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

5. **Claim and named evidence:** IUCN category assesses extinction risk, Wildlife Protection Act schedules create domestic legal consequences, and CITES regulates international trade; the three systems are related but distinct.

**Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence. **Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

6. **Claim and named evidence:** Routed demands cover old Schedule VI plant implications, protected-animal provisions and a 2024 Indian Flying Fox vermin question; each must be answered at its legal time point without inferring an option key. **Analysis:** Connect the defined system/taxon and named evidence -> ecological mechanism or legal/institutional instrument -> implementation pathway -> ecological and social consequence.

**Qualification:** State scale, stock/flow, parameter/unit, source/date/status, jurisdiction, uncertainty, causal limit, exception or residual risk.

**Counter-position / limit:** A designation, schedule, COP decision, policy target, budget, installed capacity, registration, treatment capacity or chronological association cannot alone establish ecological recovery, compliance, attribution or net climate benefit; test mechanism, monitoring, counterfactual and implementation.

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